

ONLINE APPENDIX FOR “SOCIAL IDENTITY AND LEARNING: BELIEFS AND PREFERENCES”

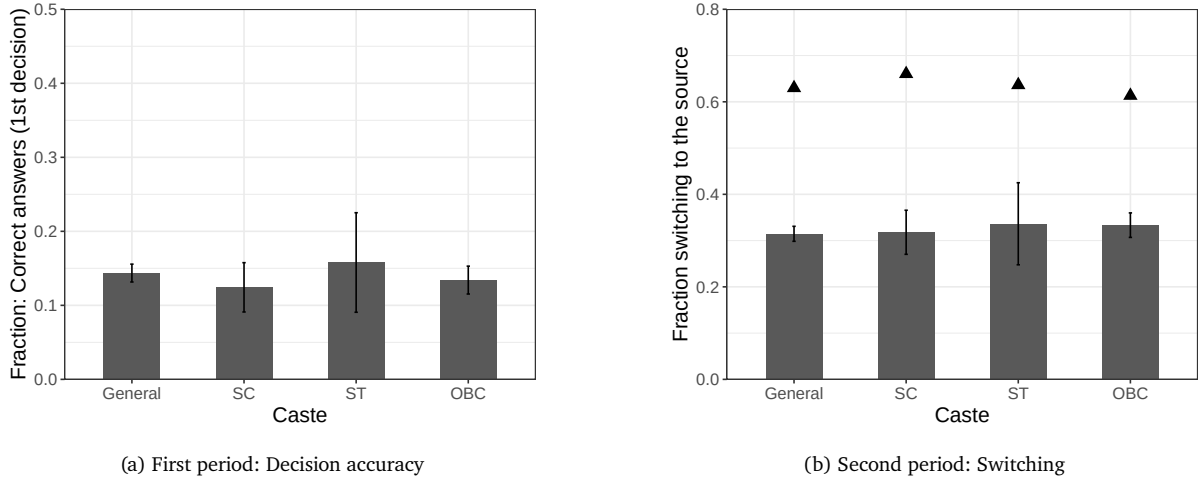
September 20, 2026

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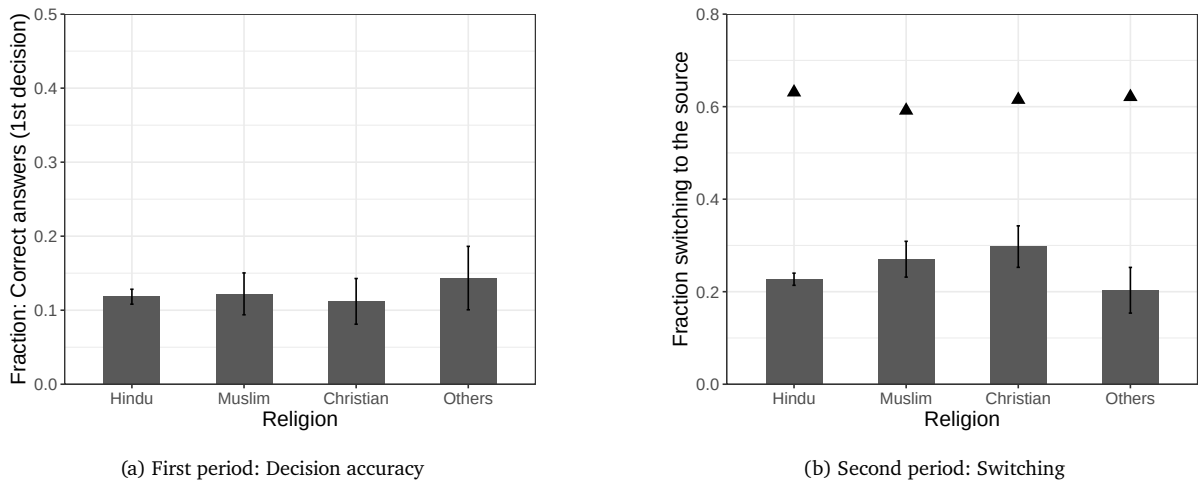
A Additional Figures

Figure A.1: Experiment *Caste*: Task performance and switching rates for each caste group.



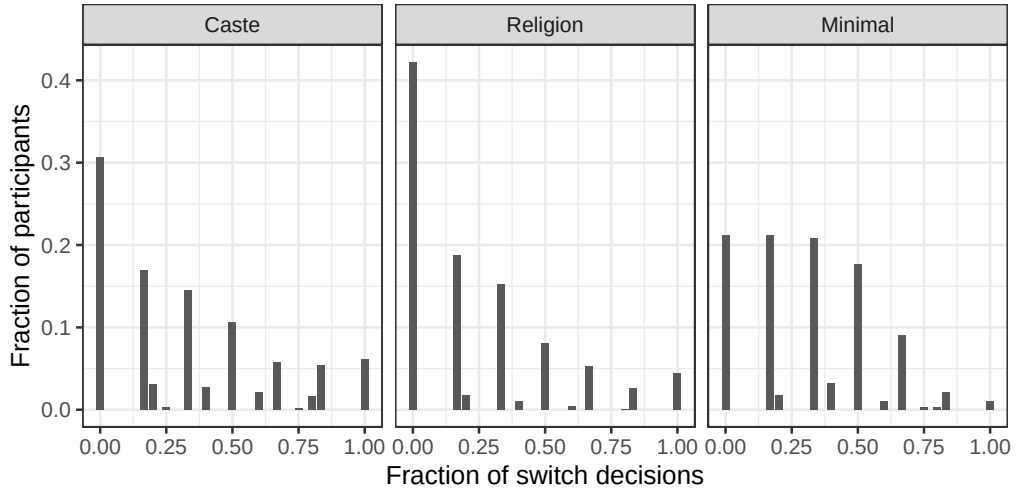
Notes. Panel (a): Bars indicate the fraction of decisions where participants made an incentive-yielding decision in the first period in experiment *Caste*. Panel (b): Bars indicate the fraction of decisions in which participants chose to switch to the source in the second period in experiment *Caste*. Triangles indicate the fraction of decisions where switching to y_s would have been incentive-yielding. Error bars indicate 95% confidence intervals.

Figure A.2: Experiment *Religion*: Task performance and switching rates for each religion.



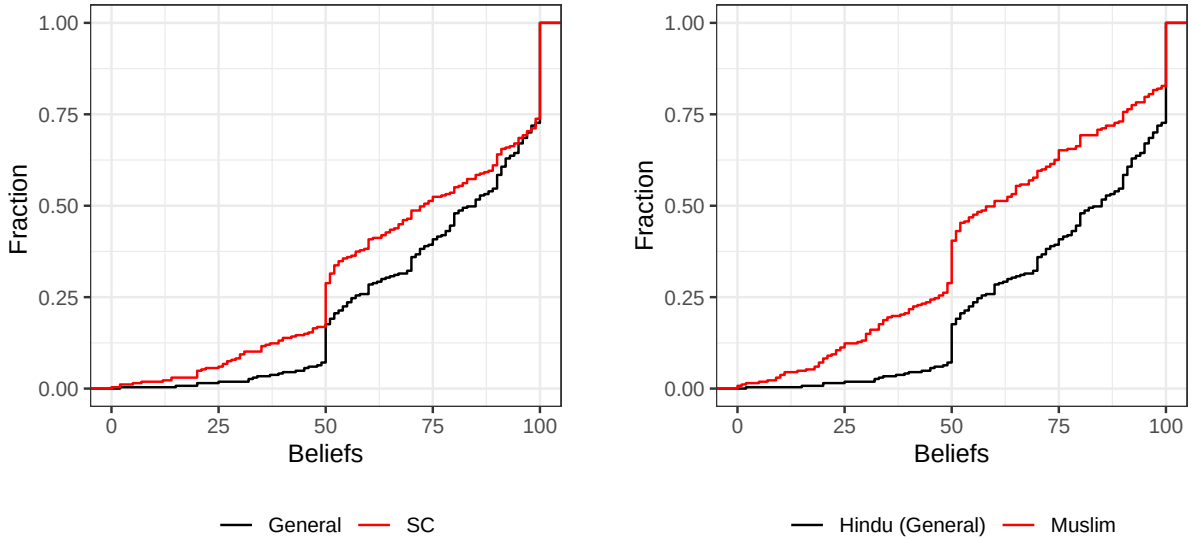
Notes. Panel (a): Bars indicate the fraction of decisions where participants made an incentive-yielding decision in the first period in experiment *Religion*. (b): Bars indicate the fraction of decisions in which participants chose to switch to the source in the second period in experiment *Religion*. Triangles indicate the fraction of decisions where switching to y_s would have been incentive-yielding. Error bars indicate 95% confidence intervals.

Figure A.3: Distribution of switching decisions – participant level



Notes. The graph shows the participant-level distribution of the fraction of second-period decisions in which participants switched to the source, separately for each experiment. Note that in some cases the fraction is not a multiple of $1/6$ as some decisions are excluded.

Figure A.4: Beliefs about the performance of different groups

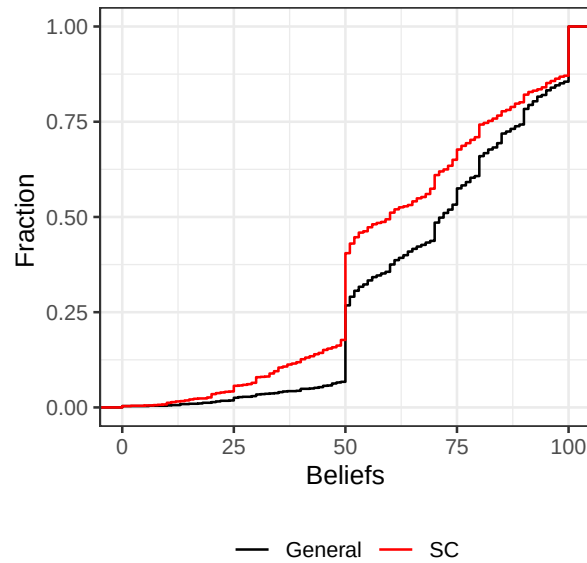


(a) Caste: High vs. low status

(b) Religion: Hindus vs. Muslims

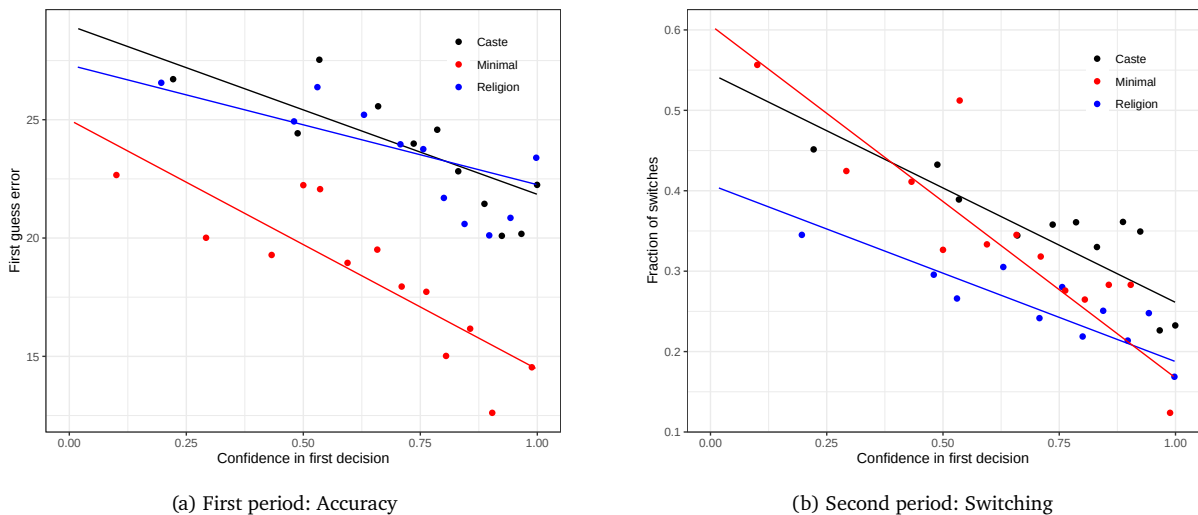
Notes. Cumulative frequencies of participants' beliefs about the likelihood that a person from a particular caste category or religion makes an accurate first-period estimate in the task. Panel (a) – Red line: SC category Hindu, Black line: G category Hindu. Panel (b) – Red line: Muslim, Black line: G category Hindu. Sample: Hindu participants in the beliefs survey.

Figure A.5: Post-treatment beliefs about the performance of different groups (Caste Experiments)



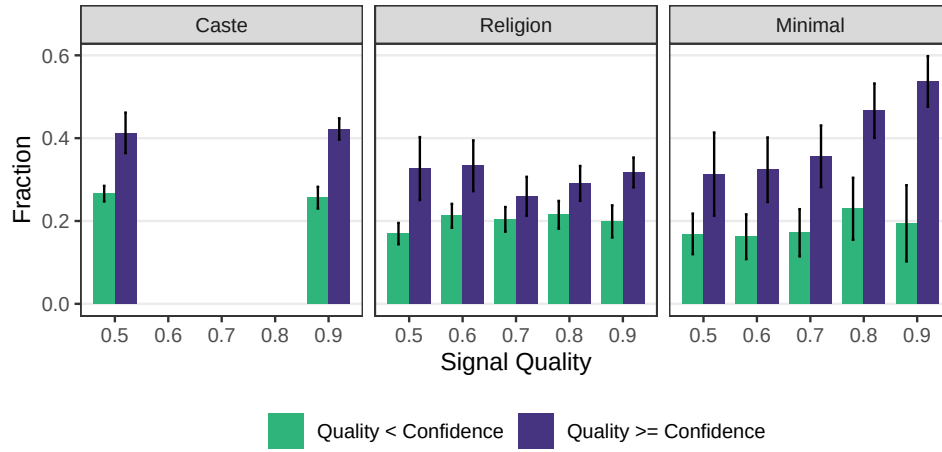
Notes. Cumulative frequencies of participants' beliefs about the likelihood that a person from a particular caste category makes an accurate first-period estimate in the task. Red line: SC category Hindu, Black line: G category Hindu. These beliefs were elicited post-treatment in the *Caste* experiments.

Figure A.6: Confidence: Task performance and switching



Notes. Binned scatter plots showing the relationship between the participants' stated confidence in the accuracy of their first-period decision and (a): the error in the first-period decision, and (b): the likelihood of switching to the source's estimate. Results are shown pooling treatment conditions in each experiment.

Figure A.7: Confidence vs. quality: Switching patterns



Notes. The graph shows the fraction of decisions where participants choose to switch to the source by the quality of the source. The light coloured bars are switching rates when source quality is lower than participants' confidence in their first-period decision; dark coloured bars are switching rates when quality is greater than or equal to confidence. Error bars indicate 95% confidence intervals.

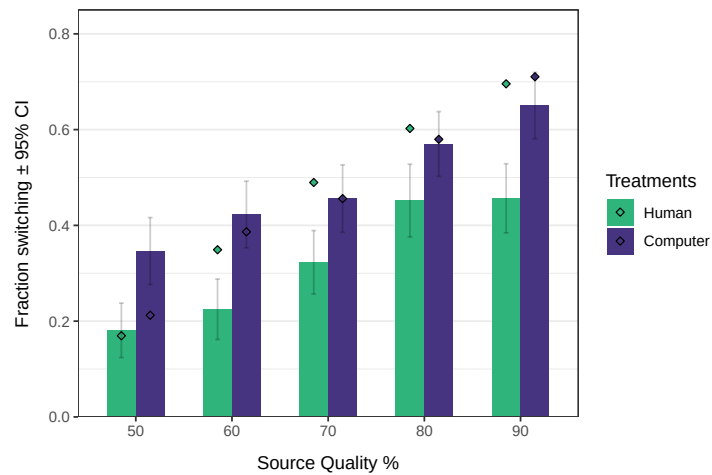


Figure A.8: Fraction of decisions where participants choose to switch to the source in treatments *Human* and *Computer*, by the quality of information. The diamonds indicate the fraction of decisions in which source quality exceeded confidence and the first-period estimate was incorrect. Error bars indicate 95% confidence intervals.

B Additional Tables

Table B.1: List of balls and urns tasks

#	Base Rate (p)	Red Balls (θ)	Total (Red) Draws	True Value (y_T)	Correct	Incorrect
1	0.7	70	3 (1)	50	51 (50)	25 (26)
2	0.7	70	5 (2)	50	48	26 (70)
3	0.9	70	3 (2)	95.5	95 (97)	76
4	0.9	90	3 (0)	1.2	3	23 (20)
5	0.9	70	5 (4)	99	97	82 (80)
6	0.5	70	5 (4)	92.7	92 (93)	77

Notes. Base rate is the probability with which urn A is selected. Red balls is the number of red balls in urn A. Total (red) draws is the number of balls that are drawn from the selected urn, with the number of red balls drawn in brackets. True value is the Bayesian posterior probability that urn A was selected. Correct and Incorrect values for the source in each task are selected from responses on the same tasks in a previous study using the procedure described in Section 2. In the last two columns, values in brackets are the values shown in the *Caste* experiments.

Table B.2: Sample Descriptives – *Caste*

	Full sample	General source	SC/ST source	Diff. (p-value)
Age	31.71 (10.18)	31.46 (9.84)	31.94 (10.5)	0.49
% Men	52.35	50.48	54.13	0.29
% College	90.13	92.29	88.07	0.04
% Employed	84.14	84.1	84.17	0.98
Joint F-test: demographics				0.19
<i>Caste category</i>				
% General	63.69	63.86	63.53	0.92
% SC	7.4	8.19	6.65	0.39
% ST	2.23	0.96	3.44	0.01
% OBC	24.68	25.06	24.31	0.8
% Prefer not to say	2	1.93	2.06	0.89
Participants	851	415	436	
Decisions	5,106	2,490	2,616	

Notes. The table reports the mean and standard deviation (in parentheses) for age and percentages for all indicator variables. College and Employment are indicator variables = 1 if the participant has tertiary education or is not unemployed. Percentages are calculated among participants with non-missing responses. The final column displays the p-values from OLS regressions of each variable on the treatment indicator.

SC - Scheduled Castes, ST - Scheduled Tribes, OBC - Other Backward Classes.

Table B.3: Sample Descriptives – *Religion*

	Full sample	Hindu source	Muslim source	Diff. (p-value)
Age	30.73 (9.6)	30.86 (9.6)	30.6 (9.62)	0.7
% Men	59.91	60.32	59.48	0.8
% College	88.63	90.02	87.2	0.2
% Employed	83.35	84.22	82.46	0.49
Joint F-test: demographics				0.76
<i>Religion</i>				
% Buddhist	1.06	1.16	0.95	0.76
% Christian	7.85	6.96	8.77	0.33
% Hindu	75.85	77.49	74.17	0.26
% Jain	1.17	0.46	1.9	0.05
% Muslim	10.08	9.98	10.19	0.92
% Sikh	1.52	2.09	0.95	0.17
% Other	0.82	0.46	1.18	0.24
% None/prefer not to say	1.64	1.39	1.9	0.56
Participants	853	431	422	
Decisions	5,118	2,586	2,532	

Notes. The table reports the mean and standard deviation (in parentheses) for age and percentages for all indicator variables. College and Employment are indicator variables = 1 if the participant has tertiary education or is not unemployed. Percentages are calculated among participants with non-missing responses. The final column displays the p-values from OLS regressions of each variable on the treatment indicator.

Table B.4: Sample Descriptives – *Minimal*

	Full sample	In-group source	Out-group source	Diff. (p-value)
Age	31.82 (10.68)	31.18 (10.1)	32.49 (11.26)	0.31
% Men	60.22	61.43	58.96	0.68
% College	76.26	77.46	75	0.63
% Employed	68.35	62.68	74.26	0.04
Joint F-test: demographics				0.26
Participants	278	142	136	
Decisions	1,668	852	816	

Notes. The table reports the mean and standard deviation (in parentheses) for age and percentages for all indicator variables. College and Employment are indicator variables = 1 if the participant has tertiary education or is not unemployed. Percentages are calculated among participants with non-missing responses. The final column displays the p-values from OLS regressions of each variable on the treatment indicator.

Table B.5: Regression analysis: Average treatment effects – Caste

	Dep. var.: Switch to source							
	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)	(vii)	(viii)
General Caste Source	-0.028 (0.021)	-0.028 (0.021)	-0.028 (0.021)	-0.027 (0.021)	-0.033 (0.021)	-0.033 (0.021)	-0.033 (0.021)	-0.033 (0.021)
Quality		0.154*** (0.036)	0.152*** (0.036)	0.150*** (0.036)	0.153*** (0.035)	0.141*** (0.038)	0.142*** (0.038)	0.141*** (0.038)
Confidence (c)					-0.315*** (0.042)	-0.315*** (0.042)	-0.315*** (0.042)	-0.315*** (0.042)
Source is wrong ($y_S \neq y_T$)						-0.012 (0.016)	-0.012 (0.016)	-0.012 (0.016)
Dist. to Source ($ y_S - y_1 $)							0.055 (0.035)	0.054 (0.035)
General Caste								-0.015 (0.022)
Constant	0.334*** (0.015)	0.226*** (0.029)	0.207*** (0.034)	0.208*** (0.056)	0.417*** (0.062)	0.428*** (0.064)	0.412*** (0.065)	0.417*** (0.065)
Task controls			✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Demog. controls				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R ²	0.001	0.005	0.007	0.011	0.035	0.035	0.035	0.036
Dependent variable mean	0.320	0.320	0.320	0.320	0.320	0.320	0.320	0.320
Observations	4,952	4,952	4,952	4,952	4,952	4,952	4,952	4,952
Individuals	851	851	851	851	851	851	851	851

Notes. Average treatment effects in experiment *Caste*, estimates from OLS regressions of Equation 2. Controls are task and order fixed effects, whether the source is correct, and demographic characteristics (the participant's age and dummies for employment, college education and gender). Robust standard errors, clustered at the participant level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Table B.6: Regression analysis: Average treatment effects – Religion

	Dep. var.: Switch to source							
	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)	(vii)	(viii)
Hindu Source	-0.010 (0.019)	-0.011 (0.019)	-0.011 (0.019)	-0.009 (0.019)	-0.007 (0.019)	-0.007 (0.019)	-0.007 (0.019)	-0.006 (0.019)
Quality		0.163*** (0.043)	0.164*** (0.043)	0.163*** (0.043)	0.160*** (0.043)	0.124*** (0.045)	0.123*** (0.045)	0.126*** (0.045)
Confidence (c)					-0.225*** (0.038)	-0.225*** (0.038)	-0.231*** (0.037)	-0.228*** (0.037)
Source is wrong ($y_S \neq y_T$)						-0.038*** (0.014)	-0.038*** (0.014)	-0.038*** (0.014)
Dist. to Source ($ y_S - y_1 $)							0.221*** (0.035)	0.223*** (0.035)
Hindu								-0.043* (0.023)
Constant	0.241*** (0.014)	0.126*** (0.033)	0.111*** (0.035)	0.183*** (0.055)	0.346*** (0.061)	0.383*** (0.063)	0.326*** (0.063)	0.350*** (0.065)
Task controls			✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Demog. controls				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R ²	0.000	0.003	0.006	0.008	0.023	0.025	0.036	0.038
Dependent variable mean	0.236	0.236	0.236	0.236	0.236	0.236	0.236	0.236
Observations	5,063	5,063	5,063	5,063	5,063	5,063	5,063	5,063
Individuals	853	853	853	853	853	853	853	853

Notes. Average treatment effects in experiment *Religion*, estimates from OLS regressions of Equation 2. Controls are task and order fixed effects, whether the source is correct, and demographic characteristics (the participant's age and dummies for employment, college education and gender). Robust standard errors, clustered at the participant level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Table B.7: Regression analysis: Average treatment effects – Minimal identity

	Dep. var.: Switch to source						
	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)	(vii)
In-group Source	-0.018 (0.028)	-0.024 (0.029)	-0.024 (0.029)	-0.029 (0.029)	-0.009 (0.027)	-0.010 (0.027)	-0.009 (0.027)
Quality		0.665*** (0.086)	0.662*** (0.087)	0.660*** (0.088)	0.667*** (0.087)	0.614*** (0.092)	0.615*** (0.091)
Confidence (c)					-0.468*** (0.054)	-0.468*** (0.054)	-0.460*** (0.055)
Source is wrong ($y_S \neq y_T$)						-0.049* (0.026)	-0.052** (0.026)
Dist. to Source ($ y_S - y_1 $)							0.238*** (0.069)
Constant	0.321*** (0.019)	-0.144** (0.062)	-0.105 (0.071)	-0.045 (0.093)	0.182* (0.092)	0.232** (0.095)	0.181* (0.096)
Task controls			✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Demog. controls				✓	✓	✓	✓
R ²	0.000	0.041	0.045	0.051	0.110	0.113	0.120
Dependent variable mean	0.312	0.312	0.312	0.312	0.312	0.312	0.312
Observations	1,629	1,629	1,629	1,629	1,629	1,629	1,629
Individuals	278	278	278	278	278	278	278

Notes. Average treatment effects in experiment *Minimal*, estimates from OLS regressions of Equation 2. Controls are task and order fixed effects, whether the source is correct, and demographic characteristics (the participant's age and dummies for employment, college education and gender). Robust standard errors, clustered at the participant level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Table B.8: Regression analysis: Experiment *Caste* – No Signal.

	Dep. var.: Switch to source							
	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)	(vii)	(viii)
General Caste Source	-0.025 (0.034)	-0.027 (0.034)	-0.026 (0.034)	-0.025 (0.034)	-0.021 (0.034)	-0.021 (0.034)	-0.020 (0.034)	-0.020 (0.034)
Quality		0.074 (0.057)	0.083 (0.056)	0.080 (0.056)	0.085 (0.055)	0.048 (0.060)	0.049 (0.060)	0.049 (0.060)
Confidence (c)					-0.195*** (0.064)	-0.197*** (0.064)	-0.197*** (0.064)	-0.197*** (0.065)
Source is wrong ($y_S \neq y_T$)						-0.035 (0.025)	-0.035 (0.025)	-0.035 (0.025)
Dist. to Source ($ y_S - y_1 $)							0.027 (0.056)	0.027 (0.056)
General Caste								0.001 (0.038)
Constant	0.285*** (0.025)	0.234*** (0.047)	0.137*** (0.052)	0.280*** (0.093)	0.417*** (0.102)	0.457*** (0.103)	0.449*** (0.103)	0.449*** (0.104)
Task controls			✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Demog. controls				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R ²	0.001	0.002	0.014	0.022	0.031	0.032	0.032	0.032
Dependent variable mean	0.273	0.273	0.273	0.273	0.273	0.273	0.273	0.273
Observations	1,719	1,719	1,719	1,719	1,719	1,719	1,719	1,719
Individuals	295	295	295	295	295	295	295	295

Notes. Average treatment effects in the *Caste* – No Signal experiment. In this experiment, the quality signal is not displayed to participants. Controls are task and order fixed effects, and demographic characteristics (the participant's age and dummies for employment, college education and gender). Standard errors are clustered at the participant level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Table B.9: Treatment effects: Equivalence tests

Experiment	Est. (pp)	SE (pp)	90% CI (pp)	TOST ± 5	TOST ± 10	95% CI (pp)	Quality 40 pp effect
<i>Caste</i>	-3.3	2.1	[-6.7, 0.1]	No	Yes	[-7.3, 0.8]	5.6
<i>Religion</i>	-0.7	1.9	[-3.8, 2.4]	Yes	Yes	[-4.4, 3.0]	5.0
<i>Minimal</i>	-1.0	2.7	[-5.4, 3.4]	No	Yes	[-6.2, 4.3]	24.6
<i>Caste – No Signal</i>	-2.1	3.4	[-7.6, 3.5]	No	Yes	[-8.7, 4.5]	–

Notes. Estimates are reported in percentage points, and follow the specification in Equation 2. “TOST” (two one-sided tests) reports whether equivalence within the stated bounds (± 5 or ± 10 pp) is established at the 5% significance level. The tests use standard errors clustered at the participant level.

Table B.10: Regression analysis: Average treatment effects – Religion (Hindu and Muslim subsample)

	Dep. var.: Switch to source							
	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)	(vii)	(viii)
Hindu Source	-0.007 (0.021)	-0.007 (0.021)	-0.007 (0.021)	-0.006 (0.021)	-0.004 (0.020)	-0.003 (0.020)	-0.003 (0.020)	-0.002 (0.020)
Quality		0.135*** (0.047)	0.135*** (0.047)	0.135*** (0.047)	0.132*** (0.046)	0.088* (0.049)	0.086* (0.049)	0.090* (0.049)
Confidence (<i>c</i>)					-0.206*** (0.039)	-0.206*** (0.039)	-0.214*** (0.039)	-0.212*** (0.039)
Source is wrong ($y_S \neq y_T$)						-0.046*** (0.015)	-0.046*** (0.015)	-0.046*** (0.015)
Dist. to Source ($ y_S - y_1 $)							0.229*** (0.038)	0.229*** (0.038)
Hindu								-0.044 (0.035)
Constant	0.233*** (0.015)	0.138*** (0.035)	0.132*** (0.038)	0.173*** (0.060)	0.326*** (0.067)	0.371*** (0.069)	0.312*** (0.069)	0.345*** (0.073)
Task controls			✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Demog. controls				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R ²	0.000	0.002	0.006	0.006	0.019	0.021	0.033	0.034
Dependent variable mean	0.230	0.230	0.230	0.230	0.230	0.230	0.230	0.230
Observations	4,348	4,348	4,348	4,348	4,348	4,348	4,348	4,348
Individuals	733	733	733	733	733	733	733	733

Notes. Average treatment effects in experiment *Religion*, estimates from OLS regressions of Equation 2, restricting the sample to only Hindu and Muslim participants. Controls are task and order fixed effects, whether the source is correct, and demographic characteristics (the participant's age and dummies for employment, college education and gender). Robust standard errors, clustered at the participant level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Table B.11: Regression analysis: Heterogeneity in the Caste experiment

	<i>Dep. var.: Switch to source</i>					
	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)
General Caste Source	-0.028 (0.053)	-0.035 (0.022)	0.015 (0.069)	-0.024 (0.021)	-0.024 (0.025)	-0.031 (0.022)
General Caste Source $\times$ Quality	-0.006 (0.071)					
General Caste Source $\times$ Source is wrong ($y_S \neq y_T$)		0.009 (0.030)				
General Caste Source $\times$ Confidence			-0.060 (0.082)			
General Caste Source $\times$ Guess 1 correct ($ y_1 - y_T \leq 2$)				-0.061* (0.037)		
General Caste Source $\times$ Dist. to Source					-0.036 (0.063)	
General Caste Source $\times$ Decision time (z)						0.008 (0.017)
Quality	0.144*** (0.054)	0.141*** (0.038)	0.145*** (0.039)	0.142*** (0.038)	0.142*** (0.038)	0.148*** (0.040)
Source is wrong ($y_S \neq y_T$)	-0.012 (0.016)	-0.016 (0.022)	-0.010 (0.016)	-0.009 (0.016)	-0.011 (0.016)	-0.007 (0.017)
Confidence (c)	-0.315*** (0.042)	-0.315*** (0.042)	-0.326*** (0.061)	-0.304*** (0.041)	-0.315*** (0.041)	-0.318*** (0.044)
Guess 1 correct ($ y_1 - y_T \leq 2$)				-0.071** (0.029)		
Dist. to Source ($ y_S - y_1 $)					0.074 (0.048)	
Decision time (z)						0.021 (0.014)
Constant	0.426*** (0.070)	0.429*** (0.064)	0.431*** (0.074)	0.415*** (0.064)	0.408*** (0.066)	0.434*** (0.069)
Task controls	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Demog. controls	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R ²	0.035	0.035	0.039	0.040	0.036	0.038
Dependent variable mean	0.320	0.320	0.320	0.320	0.320	0.312
Observations	4,952	4,952	4,907	4,952	4,952	4,346
Individuals	851	851	850	851	851	843

Notes. The table presents estimates from OLS regressions of switching on the treatment indicator interacted with one of six variables within the *Caste* experiment, controlling for demographics, task parameters, and task order. Demographic controls are the participant's age and dummies for employment, college education and gender. Standard errors are clustered at the participant level. *Quality* is a continuous variable ranging from 0.5 to 0.9. *Source is wrong* = 1 if the source's estimate is incorrect. *Confidence* is a participant's confidence in the accuracy of their independent estimate (0 to 1). *Guess 1 correct* = 1 if the participant made a correct first-period estimate. *Dist. to source* = $|y_S - y_1|$. *Decision time* is the z-standardised time taken by the participant on the page where they decide whether to stick or switch. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Table B.12: Regression analysis: Heterogeneity in the Religion experiment

	<i>Dep. var.: Switch to source</i>					
	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)
Hindu Source	0.137** (0.062)	-0.005 (0.021)	-0.043 (0.065)	0.000 (0.020)	-0.009 (0.021)	-0.006 (0.020)
Hindu Source $\times$ Quality	-0.205** (0.085)					
Hindu Source $\times$ Source is wrong ($y_S \neq y_T$)		-0.007 (0.026)				
Hindu Source $\times$ Confidence			0.045 (0.076)			
Hindu Source $\times$ Guess 1 correct ($ y_1 - y_T \leq 2$)				-0.053 (0.034)		
Hindu Source $\times$ Dist. to Source					0.006 (0.062)	
Hindu Source $\times$ Decision time (z)						-0.013 (0.016)
Quality	0.230*** (0.063)	0.124*** (0.045)	0.128*** (0.045)	0.125*** (0.045)	0.123*** (0.045)	0.115** (0.048)
Source is wrong ($y_S \neq y_T$)	-0.038*** (0.014)	-0.034* (0.019)	-0.040*** (0.014)	-0.038*** (0.014)	-0.038*** (0.014)	-0.031** (0.015)
Confidence (c)	-0.225*** (0.038)	-0.225*** (0.038)	-0.251*** (0.058)	-0.218*** (0.038)	-0.231*** (0.037)	-0.231*** (0.039)
Guess 1 correct ($ y_1 - y_T \leq 2$)				-0.056** (0.026)		
Dist. to Source ($ y_S - y_1 $)					0.218*** (0.048)	
Decision time (z)						0.040*** (0.013)
Constant	0.308*** (0.070)	0.382*** (0.064)	0.400*** (0.071)	0.380*** (0.063)	0.327*** (0.063)	0.367*** (0.066)
Task controls	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Demog. controls	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R ²	0.026	0.025	0.025	0.029	0.036	0.032
Dependent variable mean	0.236	0.236	0.235	0.236	0.236	0.230
Observations	5,063	5,063	5,027	5,063	5,063	4,398
Individuals	853	853	853	853	853	847

Notes. The table presents estimates from OLS regressions of switching on the treatment indicator interacted with one of six variables within the *Religion* experiment, controlling for demographics, task parameters, and task order. Demographic controls are the participant's age and dummies for employment, college education and gender. Standard errors are clustered at the participant level. *Quality* is a continuous variable ranging from 0.5 to 0.9. *Source is wrong* = 1 if the source's estimate is incorrect. Confidence is a participant's confidence in the accuracy of their independent estimate (0 to 1). *Guess 1 correct* = 1 if the participant made a correct first-period estimate. *Dist. to source* = $|y_S - y_1|$. *Decision time* is the z-standardised time taken by the participant on the page where they decide whether to stick or switch. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Table B.13: Regression analysis: Heterogeneity in the Minimal experiment

	Dep. var.: Switch to source					
	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)
In-group Source	0.070 (0.120)	-0.021 (0.032)	-0.039 (0.077)	-0.005 (0.029)	-0.009 (0.034)	-0.012 (0.027)
In-group Source $\times$ Quality	-0.113 (0.172)					
In-group Source $\times$ Source is wrong ($y_S \neq y_T$)		0.037 (0.048)				
In-group Source $\times$ Confidence			0.039 (0.100)			
In-group Source $\times$ Guess 1 correct ($ y_1 - y_T \leq 2$)				-0.008 (0.054)		
In-group Source $\times$ Dist. to Source					-0.002 (0.130)	
In-group Source $\times$ Decision time (z)						0.011 (0.025)
Quality	0.674*** (0.131)	0.611*** (0.092)	0.622*** (0.092)	0.615*** (0.090)	0.615*** (0.092)	0.592*** (0.094)
Source is wrong ($y_S \neq y_T$)	-0.048* (0.026)	-0.068* (0.035)	-0.050* (0.026)	-0.047* (0.026)	-0.052** (0.026)	-0.045* (0.026)
Confidence (c)	-0.469*** (0.054)	-0.468*** (0.054)	-0.477*** (0.071)	-0.437*** (0.054)	-0.460*** (0.054)	-0.468*** (0.055)
Guess 1 correct ($ y_1 - y_T \leq 2$)				-0.132*** (0.038)		
Dist. to Source ($ y_S - y_1 $)					0.239*** (0.092)	
Decision time (z)						0.071*** (0.019)
Constant	0.191 (0.120)	0.241** (0.094)	0.237** (0.100)	0.225** (0.094)	0.181* (0.096)	0.152 (0.098)
Task controls	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Demog. controls	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R ²	0.113	0.113	0.109	0.122	0.120	0.141
Dependent variable mean	0.312	0.312	0.308	0.312	0.312	0.307
Observations	1,629	1,629	1,613	1,629	1,629	1,515
Individuals	278	278	278	278	278	278

Notes. The table presents estimates from OLS regressions of switching on the treatment indicator interacted with one of six variables within the *Minimal* experiment, controlling for demographics, task parameters, and task order. Demographic controls are the participant's age and dummies for employment, college education and gender. Standard errors are clustered at the participant level. *Quality* is a continuous variable ranging from 0.5 to 0.9. *Source is wrong*=1 if the source's estimate is incorrect. Confidence is a participant's confidence in the accuracy of their independent estimate (0 to 1). *Guess 1 correct* = 1 if the participant made a correct first-period estimate. *Dist. to source* = $|y_S - y_1|$. *Decision time* is the z-standardised time taken by the participant on the page where they decide whether to stick or switch. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Table B.14: Regression analysis: Average treatment effects – Human vs. Computer

	<i>Dep. var.: Switch to source</i>						
	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)	(vii)
Computer Source	0.163*** (0.028)	0.162*** (0.027)	0.162*** (0.027)	0.170*** (0.027)	0.153*** (0.025)	0.151*** (0.025)	0.152*** (0.025)
Quality		0.764*** (0.083)	0.751*** (0.084)	0.763*** (0.083)	0.742*** (0.082)	0.668*** (0.088)	0.670*** (0.088)
Confidence (c)					-0.459*** (0.049)	-0.463*** (0.049)	-0.451*** (0.049)
Source is wrong ($y_S \neq y_T$)						-0.074*** (0.024)	-0.074*** (0.024)
Dist. to Source ($ y_S - y_1 $)							0.193*** (0.069)
Constant	0.328*** (0.020)	-0.208*** (0.058)	-0.126* (0.070)	-0.082 (0.089)	0.144 (0.089)	0.223** (0.094)	0.178* (0.095)
Task controls			✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Demog. controls				✓	✓	✓	✓
R ²	0.027	0.075	0.083	0.088	0.137	0.142	0.146
Dependent variable mean	0.412	0.412	0.412	0.412	0.412	0.412	0.412
Observations	1,844	1,844	1,844	1,844	1,844	1,844	1,844
Individuals	315	315	315	315	315	315	315

Notes. Average treatment effects in experiment *Human vs. Computer*, estimates from OLS regressions of Equation 2. Controls are task and order fixed effects, whether the source is correct, and demographic characteristics (the participant's age and dummies for employment, college education and gender). Robust standard errors, clustered at the participant level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Table B.15: Regression analysis: Heterogeneity in the Human vs. Computer experiment

	Dep. var.: Switch to source					
	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)
Computer Source	0.151 (0.113)	0.132*** (0.031)	0.188*** (0.062)	0.152*** (0.027)	0.205*** (0.033)	0.144*** (0.026)
Computer Source $\times$ Quality	0.000 (0.163)					
Computer Source $\times$ Source is wrong ($y_S \neq y_T$)		0.062 (0.045)				
Computer Source $\times$ Confidence (c)			-0.058 (0.090)			
Computer Source $\times$ Guess 1 correct ($ y_1 - y_T \leq 2$)				0.008 (0.060)		
Computer Source $\times$ Dist. to Source ($ y_S - y_1 $)					-0.304** (0.127)	
Computer Source $\times$ Decision time (z)						-0.028 (0.023)
Quality	0.668*** (0.121)	0.666*** (0.088)	0.669*** (0.088)	0.667*** (0.088)	0.671*** (0.088)	0.725*** (0.092)
Source is wrong ($y_S \neq y_T$)	-0.074*** (0.024)	-0.105*** (0.030)	-0.074*** (0.024)	-0.071*** (0.024)	-0.072*** (0.024)	-0.065** (0.026)
Confidence (c)	-0.463*** (0.049)	-0.463*** (0.049)	-0.432*** (0.066)	-0.431*** (0.050)	-0.453*** (0.048)	-0.455*** (0.050)
Guess 1 correct ($ y_1 - y_T \leq 2$)				-0.164*** (0.038)		
Dist. to Source ($ y_S - y_1 $)					0.339*** (0.091)	
Decision time (z)						0.026 (0.019)
Constant	0.223** (0.111)	0.232** (0.095)	0.203** (0.096)	0.218** (0.094)	0.156 (0.095)	0.139 (0.101)
Task controls	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Demog. controls	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R ²	0.142	0.142	0.142	0.153	0.148	0.146
Dependent variable mean	0.412	0.412	0.412	0.412	0.412	0.409
Observations	1,844	1,844	1,844	1,844	1,844	1,669
Individuals	315	315	315	315	315	315

Notes. The table presents estimates from OLS regressions of switching on the treatment indicator interacted with one of six variables within the *Computer* experiment, controlling for demographics, task parameters, and task order. Demographic controls are the participant's age and dummies for employment, college education and gender. Standard errors are clustered at the participant level. *Quality* is a continuous variable ranging from 0.5 to 0.9. *Source is wrong*=1 if the source's estimate is incorrect. Confidence is a participant's confidence in the accuracy of their independent estimate (0 to 1). *Guess 1 correct*=1 if the participant made a correct first-period estimate. *Dist. to source* = $|y_S - y_1|$. *Decision time* is the z-standardised time taken by the participant on the page where they decide whether to stick or switch. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Table B.16: Robustness – In-group preferences, *Caste* experiment

	Dep. var.: Switch to source					
	Full sample (i)	First 2 tasks (ii)	No Speeders (iii)	No speeders or slackers (iv)	Atleast 1 switch (v)	Same Task <= 10 (vi)
General Caste Source	-0.015 (0.036)	0.013 (0.044)	-0.013 (0.037)	-0.012 (0.041)	-0.029 (0.037)	-0.035 (0.046)
General Caste	-0.003 (0.032)	0.003 (0.037)	-0.015 (0.033)	-0.034 (0.035)	-0.017 (0.033)	0.012 (0.043)
General Caste Source × General Caste	-0.030 (0.044)	-0.061 (0.054)	-0.024 (0.045)	-0.016 (0.050)	-0.032 (0.046)	-0.002 (0.059)
Quality	0.144*** (0.039)	0.175*** (0.065)	0.171*** (0.044)	0.154*** (0.050)	0.158*** (0.051)	0.132** (0.052)
Constant	0.407*** (0.068)	0.417*** (0.090)	0.404*** (0.072)	0.450*** (0.082)	0.501*** (0.075)	0.510*** (0.089)
Confidence (c)	-0.306*** (0.042)	-0.380*** (0.057)	-0.325*** (0.045)	-0.333*** (0.048)	-0.249*** (0.045)	-0.347*** (0.061)
Task controls	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Demog. controls	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R ²	0.034	0.052	0.039	0.042	0.028	0.041
Dependent variable mean	0.320	0.323	0.326	0.312	0.461	0.304
Observations	4,852	1,619	3,929	2,996	3,367	2,720
Individuals	834	834	825	808	577	467

Notes. OLS estimates of Equation 3 for the robustness analysis of in-group preferences in the Caste experiment. Controls are task and order fixed effects, and demographic characteristics (the participant's age and dummies for employment, college education and gender). Standard errors are clustered at the participant level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Table B.17: Robustness – In-group preferences, *Religion* experiment

	Dep. var.: Switch to source				
	Full sample (i)	First 2 tasks (ii)	No Speeders (iii)	No speeders or slackers (iv)	Atleast 1 switch (v)
Hindu Source	0.068 (0.065)	0.025 (0.082)	0.075 (0.069)	0.061 (0.074)	0.132* (0.076)
Hindu Source × Hindu	-0.076 (0.068)	-0.008 (0.086)	-0.084 (0.072)	-0.064 (0.078)	-0.126 (0.080)
Hindu	-0.002 (0.042)	-0.020 (0.055)	-0.004 (0.044)	-0.009 (0.047)	0.043 (0.050)
Quality	0.080 (0.049)	0.097 (0.080)	0.128** (0.053)	0.126** (0.059)	0.159** (0.079)
Constant	0.375*** (0.079)	0.376*** (0.109)	0.362*** (0.082)	0.396*** (0.090)	0.348*** (0.104)
Confidence (c)	-0.210*** (0.039)	-0.186*** (0.059)	-0.231*** (0.042)	-0.255*** (0.044)	-0.168*** (0.051)
Task controls	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Demog. controls	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R ²	0.024	0.021	0.029	0.036	0.025
Dependent variable mean	0.228	0.229	0.236	0.225	0.406
Observations	4,264	1,421	3,627	2,814	2,398
Individuals	719	719	718	710	404

Notes. OLS estimates of Equation 3 for the robustness analysis of in-group preferences in the Religion experiment. Controls are task and order fixed effects, and demographic characteristics (the participant's age and dummies for employment, college education and gender). Standard errors are clustered at the participant level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

C Experiment details and additional analyses

C.1 Source decisions

I curated the decisions as follows:

- For each task, two decisions were selected such that at least one participant from each relevant identity group had made each decision.
- For each task, one of the decisions is within ± 2 pp of the Bayesian posterior. This is the “correct” answer.
- The second decision (“incorrect”) is chosen to be at least 15 percentage points away from the true value.

At least one participant from each treatment identity category made these decisions in each of the separate experiments and the set of decisions was the same within an experiment. For example, 51 and 25 were chosen on task 1 in the *Religion* and *Minimal* experiments, and these were provided as answers by at least one Hindu, one Muslim, one person who preferred paintings by Klee, and one person who preferred paintings by Kandinsky. In the *Caste* experiment, these values were 50 and 26, and were decisions made by at least one Hindu from the General caste group, and one Hindu from the SC/ST caste group.

C.2 Discussion: Quality signal

The design goal is to ensure that the quality signals provide precise information about the quality of the source, defined as the percentage chance with which switching to the source would yield the incentive. Source decisions were chosen at the task level in the following manner:

- A signal quality level was randomly assigned to each task. In *Caste*, this was $Q \in \{0.5, 0.9\}$, and in *Religion* and *Minimal*, this was $Q \in \{0.5, 0.6, 0.7, 0.8, 0.9\}$.
- As discussed in Appendix C.1, each task had two linked decisions of which one was correct and one was incorrect.
- With probability Q , the correct source was shown. With probability $1 - Q$, the incorrect source was shown.

Instructions

In experiment *Caste*, the following information is shown to participants:

There is a $[Q]$ % chance that this number is the correct answer.

The computer has access to a pool of participants who made correct guesses on this exact task in a previous study. They had the same information and saw the same balls as you when making their guess. The computer randomly chooses one of these people and shows you a number:

- With [Q]% probability, the shown number is the chosen person’s correct guess.
- Otherwise, the shown number is incorrect.

In experiments *Religion* and *Minimal*, the following information is shown to participants:

There is a [Q] % chance that this guess is within $\pm 2\%$ points of the correct answer.

A computer randomly chooses this guess from the guesses made on this exact task by participants in a previous study - they had the same information, and saw the same ball colours when making their guess.

In the *Computer* treatment, the following information is shown to participants:

There is a [Q] % chance that this value is within $\pm 2\%$ points of the correct answer.

Otherwise, the computer chooses a random number between 0 and 100.

In all of the above cases, Q is a placeholder for the randomly chosen probability that the source’s decision is correct (i.e. participants always see the probability).

C.3 Details on surnames used in the experiments

At the start of the experiment, participants were told that the source’s decisions were made by participants in a previous study, which was a true statement. Participants were informed at the end of the study that the names used in the *Religion* and *Caste* experiments were “fictional nicknames”.

The recognisability of the Hindu surnames used in the experiments was validated in a separate module of the beliefs survey. Participants completed the training modules and comprehension tests that were used in the main experiments before evaluating a set of 16 Hindu surnames which included the 12 surnames used in the experiments. Participants were incentivised for accurate classification. The source of truth for the incentivisation of these classifications came from official classifications of individuals belonging to these communities, or the common nature of these surnames. The recognisability of these surnames as *G* or *O* surnames ranged from $\approx 64\%$ to 90% , with names from the SC and ST castes being, on average, more recognisable than General caste surnames. The Muslim names were not validated, given the common nature and general identifiability of these names.

Hindu, General caste (*G*) surnames used in both the *Caste* and *Religion* experiments. Iyer, Banerjee, Chaturvedi, Tiwari, Bharadwaj, Mishra. Validation accuracy: 64–75%.

Hindu, SC/ST caste (*O*) surnames used in the *Caste* experiments. Paraiyar, Bhil, Jatav, Manjhi, Mahar, Chamar. Validation accuracy: 75–90%.

Muslim names used in the *Religion* experiment. Khan, Shaikh, Abdullah, Syed, Moinuddin, Ali.

C.4 Additional survey questions

Demographics. In all experiments, participants provide their age, sex, education level, and employment status. In the *Caste* and *Religion* experiments, participants also state their religion, caste group, religiosity, and their favourite religious festival (free text). These questions also serve as a mild priming device, drawing attention to these characteristics before the main decision tasks (as in [Chen et al. \(2014\)](#)). Participants are only asked these questions after clearing the attention and comprehension tests.

Exposure and Attitudes. Participants in the *Caste* experiments respond to three additional survey questions after they complete the main tasks. The first two elicit the extent to which respondents have close associations with people who belong to their religious or caste out-groups. The questions are:

How many of your close friends belong to the same [Religion/Caste category] as you?

The final question elicits people's attitudes towards caste-based affirmative action policies.

Do you support reservations in jobs and educational institutions based on caste?

Beliefs – Group performance. Participants in the *Caste* experiments state their beliefs about the probability that an anonymous person belonging to the General or SC caste group would answer the experimental task correctly. These beliefs are incentivised for accuracy – participants earn an additional \$0.50 if they guess the number within ± 5 pp of the true probability, which is calculated based on a previous study. These questions are asked for the “General” and “Scheduled Castes” caste groups.

If a randomly selected individual belonging to the [Caste group] category attempted the Decision task (the task that you just completed), what do you believe is the probability (0% to 100%) that they will answer it correctly? 0% means that they will never get it correct. 100% means that they will always get it correct.

Reflection question. After completing the survey, respondents provide free-text responses to:

Please tell us what you thought about when making the second decisions in the tasks.

How did you think about the choice of using your own decision or the shown number?

Individualism. Experiments *Religion*, *Minimal*, and *Human v. Computer* included 8 additional questions that measured horizontal and vertical individualism. These measures were taken from the scale developed by [Triandis and Gelfand \(1998\)](#). These questions were selected from the original battery based on relevance to the link between individualism and a preference for consistency/autonomy. Answers are coded on a scale from 1 to 5, with 1 indicating “Strongly disagree” and 5 indicating “Strongly agree”.

The questions are:

I would rather depend on myself than others.
I rely on myself most of the time. I rarely rely on others.
I often do my own thing.
My personal identity, independent of others, is very important to me.
It is important that I do my job better than others.
Winning is everything.
Competition is the law of nature.
When another person does better than I do, I get tense.

Summing up the responses to these questions results in an “Individualism” score for each participant.

C.5 Experiment *Caste – No signal*

This experiment was conducted at the same time as the *Caste* experiment, and participants were recruited from the same sampling pool. Participants were given a quality signal in the *Caste* experiment, but not in *Caste – No Signal*.

The following information is presented to participants in this experiment group, instead of the quality signal:

The computer has access to a pool of participants who made guesses on this exact task in a previous study. They had the same information and saw the same balls as you when making their guess. The computer randomly chooses one of these people and shows you the chosen person’s guess.

Learning with and without a signal

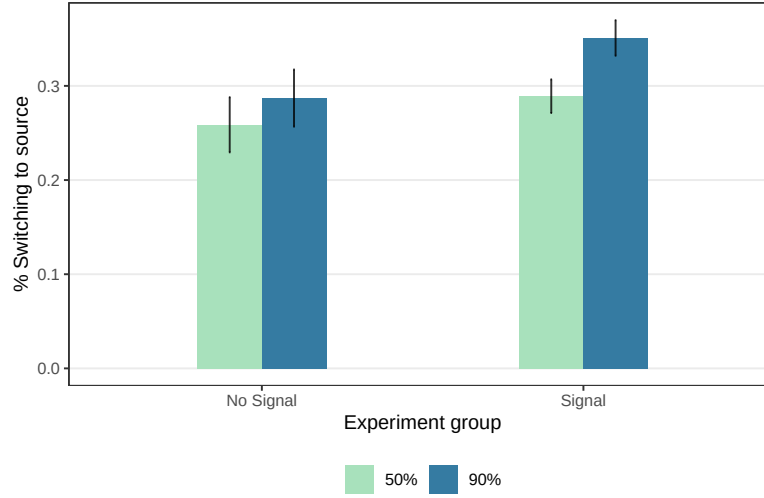
A comparison of decisions in these experiments shows that participants switch more when given the quality signal. The difference is more pronounced when the signal is stronger – Appendix Figure C.1 shows that when source quality is low (50%), switching in the two experiments differs by $\approx 10\%$. When the source quality is high (90%), the difference is $\approx 18\%$.

Appendix Figure C.2 presents binned scatter plots of switching on participants’ underlying beliefs about the performance of different caste groups (i.e., their belief that a person from that group will get the correct answer on the task) in these experiments. In the absence of the quality signal, switching is correlated with underlying beliefs – the left panel of Appendix Figure C.2 shows that when the quality signal is not provided, switching increases with the participant’s beliefs about the success of either the General caste group or the SC group. The right panel of Appendix Figure C.2 shows that the correlation is virtually zero when the quality signal is provided. Taken together, the patterns are consistent with a weaker link between underlying group-performance beliefs and switching.

C.6 Experiment *Computer*

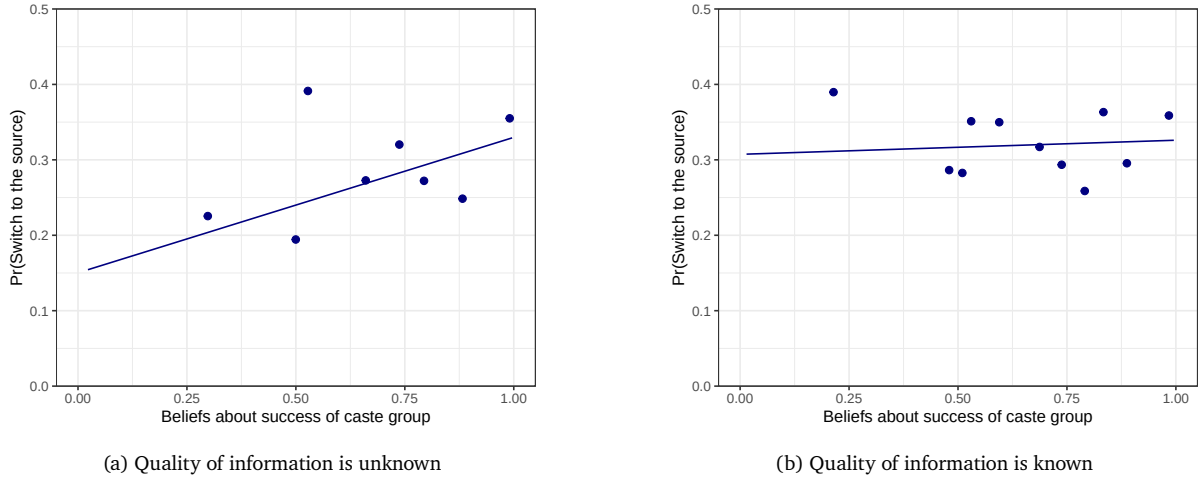
Background information. Understanding human-computer interaction has become increasingly important with developments in generative artificial intelligence and the general importance of the internet as a medium in all aspects of social and economic life. However, the evidence on whether

Figure C.1: Switching with and without the quality signal



Notes. The bars show the fraction of decisions in which participants switch to the source. In the first group, signal quality is not revealed to participants (experiment *Caste – No Signal*). In the second group, participants are informed of the signal quality (experiment *Caste*). Light coloured bars indicate the fraction switching under a 50% quality signal, and dark bars indicate the same for a 90% quality signal. Error bars indicate 95% confidence intervals.

Figure C.2: Role of underlying beliefs



Notes. Binned scatter plots of participants' likelihood of switching to a source (with an experimentally assigned caste identity) against incentivised beliefs about the likelihood that a random individual of that caste makes a correct decision on the task. (a): *Caste – No Signal*, participants are not informed about the quality of the source. (b): *Caste*, participants are given the quality signal.

people learn more from humans or computers is mixed. While some find that people are more averse to learning from algorithms than from other humans (Goeree and Yariv, 2015; Dietvorst et al., 2018, 2015), others find evidence of algorithm appreciation (Logg et al., 2019). Hou and Jung (2021) show that appreciation or aversion emerges because of differences in framing and perceived accuracy, and Langer et al. (2022) document the sensitivity of people's responses to the terminology used to refer to the non-social source. The *Human v. Computer* experiment studies whether differences in how people learn from humans and algorithmic sources are driven by preferences for non-social sources.

This experiment also had the objective of validating the experimental paradigm.

Implementation. In this experiment, participants see either an anonymous human or a “Computer”. In treatment *Computer*, the source is labelled as “Computer”, and the human icon is replaced with a computer icon. As in the other treatments where estimates made by other humans are shown, participants are told that the signal indicates the probability that the shown estimate is correct, and that a randomly chosen number is displayed otherwise. This induces a slight increase in the perceived probability (relative to the other experiment groups) that the shown estimate is correct which does not materially affect the results. The comparison group consists of participants assigned to treatment *Human*. Sources in the *Human* treatment are labelled as “Study Participant”. All Prolific experiments were conducted simultaneously. Participants in this experiment were recruited through Prolific, and the effective sample size is 315.

C.7 Disagreement and inferring quality from source decisions

The estimates in Table C.1 show that an increase in disagreement – defined as the absolute difference between the source’s decision y_s and the participant’s first-period decision y_1 – is associated with an increase in switching in two of the three main experiments. This suggests that participants may not be willing to abandon their decision for small adjustments, but are more likely to switch when the difference is larger. This behaviour can be partially explained by a demand for partial updating, but also raises the possibility that the shown estimate provides information about the source’s accuracy; for example, seeing a decision that is very different from their own first-period decision could dissuade switching if a participant is confident. While switching is lower when the shown estimate is incorrect, switching increases with the distance between y_1 and y_s . The absolute disagreement is therefore included as an additional control in some of the specifications, although it does not affect any of the results as source quality is randomly assigned and the set of source estimates linked to a task is the same for all participants.

C.8 Psychological factors: Exposure and individualism

The *Caste* experiment elicited participants’ (i) contact with people from different castes and religions, and (ii) support for caste-based affirmative action (a proxy for the importance placed on caste identity). Appendix Figure C.3 shows the estimated coefficients of the difference in the average treatment effect between people who have fewer friends from other castes, fewer friends from other religions, are against caste-based affirmative action policies, or strongly support or oppose affirmative action relative to the rest of the sample. People who are less exposed to people from other castes or religions may have preferences for information from their in-groups (Lowe, 2021). Similarly, people who support or have strong opinions about caste-based affirmative action policies may value caste identity differently from those who oppose or have weaker opinions. The estimated specification is $\text{Switch}_{i,n} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 In_i + \beta_2 E_i + \beta_3 In_i \times E_i + Q_{i,n} + \gamma_i + \mu_n + \epsilon_i$, where $In_i = 1$ if the participant and the source are in the same caste group and E_i is an indicator variable for responses to each question. There is no evidence of heterogeneous preferences for the identity of information sources on these dimensions.

Table C.1: Regression analysis: Beliefs, additional analyses.

	Dep. var.: Switch to source							
	Caste		Religion		Minimal		Caste (No Signal)	
	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)	(vii)	(viii)
Quality	0.154*** (0.036)	0.138*** (0.038)	0.163*** (0.043)	0.124*** (0.045)	0.665*** (0.086)	0.615*** (0.090)	0.074 (0.057)	0.047 (0.059)
Beliefs (Identity group)		0.080 (0.050)						0.228*** (0.076)
Confidence (c)		-0.319*** (0.041)		-0.227*** (0.037)		-0.436*** (0.055)		-0.237*** (0.062)
Guess 1 correct ($ y_1 - y_T \leq 2$)		-0.102*** (0.021)		-0.043** (0.019)		-0.116*** (0.028)		-0.067** (0.034)
Source is wrong ($y_S \neq y_T$)		-0.010 (0.016)		-0.038** (0.014)		-0.050* (0.026)		-0.038 (0.025)
Dist. to Source ($ y_S - y_1 $)		0.000 (0.037)		0.201*** (0.038)		0.189*** (0.071)		0.000 (0.059)
Constant	0.226*** (0.029)	0.378*** (0.070)	0.126*** (0.033)	0.331*** (0.063)	-0.144** (0.062)	0.186* (0.096)	0.234*** (0.047)	0.324*** (0.114)
Task controls		✓		✓		✓		✓
Demog. controls		✓		✓		✓		✓
Treatment FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R ²	0.005	0.041	0.003	0.037	0.041	0.127	0.002	0.047
Dependent variable mean	0.320	0.320	0.236	0.236	0.312	0.312	0.273	0.273
Observations	4,952	4,952	5,063	5,063	1,629	1,629	1,719	1,719
Individuals	851	851	853	853	278	278	295	295

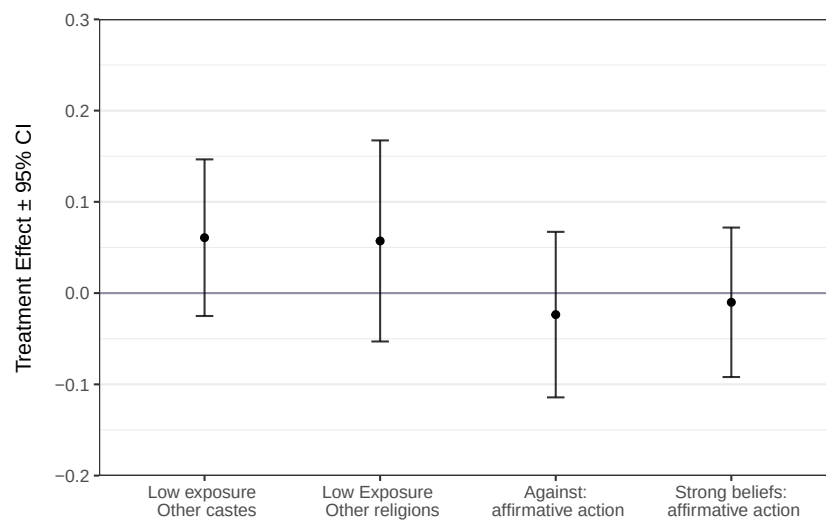
Notes. Estimates from OLS regressions where the dependent variable is whether a participant switches in the second period. The main variable of interest is *Quality*, which is the experimentally assigned quality signal. Other variables: (i) beliefs about the likelihood of success of the identity group in the assigned treatment (i.e. G or O), (ii) participant's reported confidence in first-decision (y_1) accuracy (0 to 1), (iii) whether y_1 was accurate (0/1), (iv) source correctness, and (v) disagreement, which is the absolute difference between y_S and y_1 . Controls are task and order fixed effects, demographic characteristics (the participant's age and dummies for employment, college education and gender), and controls for the identity treatment within each experiment. Robust standard errors, clustered at the participant level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Experiments *Religion* and *Minimal* included a battery of questions that measured horizontal and vertical individualism from [Triandis and Gelfand \(1998\)](#). While individualism scores are correlated with overall switching in the *Religion* experiment, there is no evidence that individualism moderates the treatment effects in these experiments.

C.9 Deviations from pre-registration

- The anonymous treatment to be conducted with the same sample as the *Religion* experiment was not implemented; instead, the participants were reallocated towards the *Religion* experiment. This was done to improve the statistical power of the *Religion* experiment.
- The pre-analysis plan stated that observations where the participant's first estimate and the source differed by 1 pp would be excluded. The main analyses exclude observations where the two are identical to maximise the number of observations in the estimation sample. The results are robust to different exclusion criteria.
- Some of the experiment names have been changed for clarity.

Figure C.3: Mechanisms: *Caste* Experiment



Notes. Results from regressions of whether participants switch on an indicator of whether participants see an in-group source, an indicator of caste identity strength, and their interaction. The figure shows the estimated coefficients of the interaction term of whether participants see an in-group source and an indicator for (i) low exposure to people from other castes, (ii) low exposure to people from other religions, (iii) whether they oppose caste-based affirmative action policies in the *Caste* experiment, and (iv) strong beliefs about caste-based affirmative action. Standard errors are clustered at the participant level.

D Experiment instructions

Experiment *Caste* – *Signal*

Welcome

This study is being conducted by researchers from the Norwegian School of Economics. It will take about 10 minutes to complete this study. Please read all questions and instructions carefully.

Payment and Bonus Rewards

- You can earn up to \$ 3.5 (~ INR 290) in additional bonuses depending on your task performance. You will be given information about the bonuses as you progress through the study.
- If you want to be eligible for the bonus, you must complete the entire study. The bonus that you earn will be shown to you at the end of the study, and will be processed and sent to you within 7 working days.
- You will need to read all the instructions carefully and answer a comprehension test correctly in order to participate in the study and be eligible for bonuses. You will have two chances to complete the comprehension test. In case you do not pass the comprehension test, you will not be eligible for any rewards.
- Bonus rewards will be paid in points, equivalent to the US dollar amount.

Guidelines

- We encourage you to try to answer all questions accurately and truthfully.
- This study is confidential and will only be used for research purposes.
- This study has been approved by an institutional review board.
- You may write to us at s14117@nhh.no in case you have any queries about this study.

Consent

By participating in this study you agree to the usage of your anonymised information and actions within the survey for research purposes.

☐

Next

Figure D.1: Welcome and consent

Instructions for the Decision Tasks (1/3)

You will do 6 of these tasks, and in each task, you will make two decisions. The instructions below apply to all tasks.

Task Description

In each task, there are two bags - a **RED** bag and a **BLACK** bag. Each bag contains 100 balls, which are either **Red** or **Black**. The **RED** bag always contains more Red balls, and the **BLACK** bag contains more black balls. You know how many balls of each colour are in a bag.

One of the bags is chosen at random, but you do not know which bag is chosen. A few balls are drawn randomly from the chosen bag. Balls are drawn one by one, and they are put back into the bag before the next one is drawn.

You are shown the colours of all the balls that were drawn from the bag. You also know the chance with which a bag can be chosen, and the number of red and black balls in each bag.

You will make **two** decisions on each task. Both decisions are **eligible for a bonus reward**.

The First Decision

Based on the composition of the bags and the colours of the drawn balls, you have to **guess the likelihood that the balls were drawn from the RED bag. This should be a number between 0 and 100 %**. 0 means that you think there is no chance the balls were drawn from the red bag, and 100 means that you are completely certain that the balls were drawn from the red bag.

Next

Figure D.2: Instructions 1/3

Instructions for the Decision Tasks (2/3)

After making the first decision, you will be shown a number.

How is this number generated?

- The computer has access to a pool of participants who made **correct guesses** on this exact task in a previous study. They had the same information and saw the same balls as you when making their guess.
- The computer randomly chooses one of these people, and shows you a number:
 - With some probability, the shown number is the chosen person's **correct** guess.
 - Otherwise, the shown number is **incorrect**.

The probability that the correct guess is shown can change from task to task.

The Second Decision

You have to make a choice:

1. Stick to your first guess, OR
2. Switch to the shown number.

Next, you will learn about how you can earn bonuses on these tasks.

Next

Figure D.3: Instructions 2/3

Instructions for the Decision Tasks (3/3)

Bonuses

- You will do 6 of these tasks, making 2 decisions in each task. **One** of these 12 decisions will be randomly selected for a bonus.
- Each task has a mathematically correct answer.
- If the chosen guess is **within $\pm 2\%$ points of the correct answer**, your bonus will be \$ 3.
- If your guess is more than 2 % away from the correct answer, then you will not earn a bonus.

It is therefore in your best interest to try and make all your guesses as accurately as possible.

Note: The correct answer to each task can be calculated using a probability formula. [Click to see formula](#)

Next, you will see an example task.

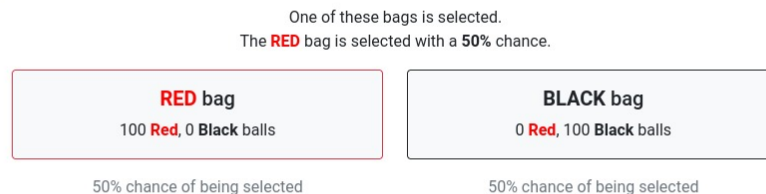
Next

Figure D.4: Instructions 3/3

Example Task (1/3)

This is an example of how the actual task will work.

Example Task



When you click the button, **3 balls** will be drawn from the selected bag one by one, with replacement. You will be allowed to make your guess after drawing the balls.

Click to draw balls

Figure D.5: Example 1/3

Example Task (1/3)

This is an example of how the actual task will work.

Example Task

One of these bags is selected.
The **RED** bag is selected with a **50%** chance.

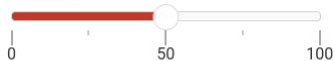
RED bag 100 Red , 0 Black balls 50% chance of being selected	BLACK bag 0 Red , 100 Black balls 50% chance of being selected
---	---

When you click the button, **3 balls** will be drawn from the selected bag one by one, with replacement. You will be allowed to make your guess after drawing the balls.

The 3 balls are: 

Make your Guess

Based on the information above, **state your guess (0-100%)** that expresses how likely you think it is that the **RED** bag was selected. Use the slider to select your answer.


0 50 100
 %

This example is also an attention check. The correct answer for this example is 100. Please select 100 to continue.

Next

Figure D.6: Example 1/3

Example Task (2/3)

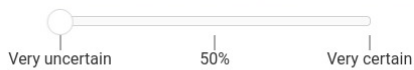
After making the first decision, you will be taken to a page that looks like the one below.

Here, you have to use the slider to tell us how certain you are that the decision that you made on the previous screen is within ± 2 % points of the correct answer. A value of 0 % means that you are not at all certain. 100 % means that you are completely certain.

Example Task

Your first guess was: **100 %** that the **RED** bag was selected.

How **certain** are you that that your guess is within ± 2 % points of the correct answer? Use the slider to select your answer.


Very uncertain 50% Very certain
 %

Next

Figure D.7: Example 2/3

Example Task (3/3)

The example continues on this page - no bonuses will be awarded for this task, but you have to provide an answer to continue to the next page.

Example Task - The Second Decision

The computer shows:



Study Participant

73

There is a **50 % chance** that this number is the correct answer.

More info:

- The computer has access to a pool of participants who made **correct guesses** on this exact task in a previous study. They had the same information and saw the same balls as you when making their guess.
- The computer randomly chooses one of these people, and shows you a number:
 - With some probability, the shown number is the chosen person's **correct** guess.
 - Otherwise, the shown number is **incorrect**.

Make your Second Decision

Your first guess was: **100 %**.

Based on the information above, **choose one of these options to make your decision (0-100%) that expresses how likely you think it is that the **RED** bag was selected.**

☐ **100 %** - Stick to your first guess

☐ **73 %** - Switch to the shown number

Next

Figure D.8: Example 3/3

Summary

Congratulations! You have successfully completed the example task.

Next, you will answer a short comprehension test. You must pass the test in order to be eligible for survey completion and bonus payments. Below is a short summary of the task, please familiarise yourself with them before moving on to the test.

Task Description

There are two bags - a **RED** bag and a **BLACK** bag. Each bag contains 100 balls, which are either **Red** or **Black**. The **RED** bag always contains more Red balls, and the **BLACK** bag contains more black balls. You know how many balls of each colour are in a bag.

One of the bags is chosen at random, and a few balls are drawn randomly from the chosen bag. Balls are drawn one by one, and they are put back into the bag before the next one is drawn. You are shown the colours of all the balls that were picked.

First decision: Based on this information, you have to **guess the likelihood that the balls were drawn from the **RED** bag. This should be a number between 0 and 100 %**.

Second decision: The second decision is made after you see what someone else has guessed on the exact same task. They have seen the same bags and drawn balls as you. A computer will show you a number. You have to decide whether to stick to your first guess, or switch to the shown number.

Important points

1. You make two decisions on each task, and there are 6 tasks.
2. Each of the Decision Tasks has a mathematically correct answer.
3. One of the decisions will be randomly chosen for a bonus. You will get a \$ 3 bonus if the chosen decision is within 2% points of the correct answer.

Click the button to proceed to the comprehension test.

Next

Figure D.9: Summary

Task Comprehension: First Attempt

You must answer all questions to proceed. You have two chances to do this. If you are unable to pass, the assignment will end immediately and you will not be eligible for approval or for any bonus rewards.

[Click here to review the instructions.](#)

1. You will make several guesses in the tasks. What exactly are you guessing?

- ☐ A number between 0-100, representing your guess about the chance that the RED bag was selected.
- ☐ The probability of a green ball being drawn.

2. Which decision will be used to calculate the bonus?

- ☐ The first decision
- ☐ The last decision
- ☐ One randomly chosen decision

3. If a decision is selected for the bonus, you will get the bonus ...

- ☐ If the selected decision is within 2 % points of the mathematically correct value.
- ☐ By correctly guessing the hard disk capacity of the computer.

4. Before making your second decision, the computer will show you a number. Which of these statements is correct?

- ☐ The shown number is always a random number.
- ☐ The shown number is either another person's correct guess, else it is an incorrect answer.

Next

Figure D.10: Comprehension (two attempts)

Survey questions

Please answer the following questions (all questions are mandatory). Accurate answers to these questions will help us in our research.

Age (in years)

Gender

- ☐ Female
- ☐ Male
- ☐ Other

Highest education level attained/in progress?

- ☐ None
- ☐ Primary
- ☐ Secondary
- ☐ Bachelors degree/diploma
- ☐ Above Bachelors

Current employment status

- ☐ Employed - Full time job
- ☐ Employed - Part time job
- ☐ Self-employed
- ☐ Not currently employed

Which state are you from?

Which religion do you belong to?

- ☐ Buddhist
- ☐ Christian
- ☐ Hindu
- ☐ Jain
- ☐ Muslim
- ☐ Sikh
- ☐ Other
- ☐ None/prefer not to say

Which category do you belong to?

- ☐ General
- ☐ SC (Scheduled Castes)
- ☐ ST (Scheduled Tribes)
- ☐ OBC (Other Backward Class)
- ☐ Prefer not to say

Which is the most important religious festival for you?

How important is religion in your life?

- ☐ Not at all important
- ☐ Not very important
- ☐ Somewhat important
- ☐ Very Important
- ☐ I do not want to answer

Next

Figure D.11: Demographics

Decision Tasks

You are now on decision task **1** of **6**.

You will be given a situation and asked to make decisions (as explained in the instructions).

Click "Next" to continue.

Next

Figure D.12: Between decision tasks

Decision Task 1 of 6

One of these bags is selected.
The **RED** bag is selected with a **50%** chance.

RED bag
70 **Red**, 30 **Black** balls

50% chance of being selected

BLACK bag
30 **Red**, 70 **Black** balls

50% chance of being selected

When you click the button, **5 balls** will be drawn from the selected bag one by one, with replacement. You will be allowed to make your guess after drawing the balls.

Click to draw balls

Make your Decision

Based on the information above, state your guess (0-100%) that expresses how likely you think it is that the **RED** bag was selected. Use the slider to select your answer.

0 50 100

%

Next

Figure D.13: Decision Tasks - First guess

Decision Task 1 of 6

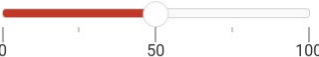
One of these bags is selected.
The **RED** bag is selected with a **50%** chance.

RED bag	BLACK bag
70 Red , 30 Black balls	30 Red , 70 Black balls
50% chance of being selected	50% chance of being selected

When you click the button, **5 balls** will be drawn from the selected bag one by one, with replacement. You will be allowed to make your guess after drawing the balls.

The 5 balls are: 

Make your Decision
Based on the information above, **state your guess (0-100%) that expresses how likely you think it is that the **RED** bag was selected.** Use the slider to select your answer.


0 50 100
 %

[Next](#)

Figure D.14: Decision Tasks - First guess

Task 1 of 6: Second Decision

1 of 6

[See task details](#)

When you click the button, the computer will show you a number. You will be allowed to make your decision after clicking the button.

[Click to proceed](#)

Figure D.15: Decision Tasks - Second decision

Task 1 of 6: Second Decision

1 of 6

[See task details](#)

The computer shows:



There is a **50 % chance** that this number is the correct answer.

More info about this guess:

- The computer has access to a pool of participants who made **correct guesses** on this exact task in a previous study. They had the same information and saw the same balls as you when making their guess.
- The computer randomly chooses one of these people, and shows you a number:
 - With 50% probability, the shown number is the chosen person's **correct** guess.
 - Otherwise, the shown number is **incorrect**.

Make your decision

Your first guess was: **5 %**.

Based on the information above, **choose one of these options to make your guess (0-100%) that expresses how likely you think it is that the **RED** bag was selected.**

- ☐ **5 %** - Stick to your first guess
- ☐ **3 %** - Switch to the shown number

Next

Figure D.16: Decision Tasks - Second decision

Survey Questions

You have successfully completed the Decision task.

Next, please answer a few questions based on the task that you just completed.

Click the button to continue.

Next

Figure D.17: Survey section

Task Reflection

Please tell us what you thought about when making the second decisions in the tasks. How did you think about the choice of using your own decision or the shown number?

Please provide a detailed response (about 20 words).

Word count:

Next

Figure D.18: Reflection question

Survey Questions

Please answer the following questions (all questions are mandatory). Accurate answers to these questions will help us in our research.

How many of your close friends have the same religion as you?

- ☐ All of them
- ☐ Most of them
- ☐ Some of them
- ☐ Hardly any of them

How many of your close friends belong to the same caste category as you?

- ☐ All of them
- ☐ Most of them
- ☐ Some of them
- ☐ Hardly any of them

Are you in favour of caste-based reservations?

- ☐ Strongly in favor
- ☐ Somewhat in favor
- ☐ Somewhat against
- ☐ Strongly against

Next

Figure D.19: Survey questions

Survey Questions

Now, you will be shown 2 questions where you have to guess the performance of people on the Decision task.

You can earn a bonus reward from these questions: One of the questions will be randomly selected for a bonus. If your answer to this question was correct, you will earn a \$0.50 reward.

A correct answer to this question is an answer that is **within ± 5 %** of the actual value. The actual value will be calculated from the responses provided by participants in a previous study. You will be shown the bonus amount for this part on the last page of this survey.

Click the button to continue.

Next

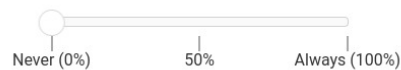
Figure D.20: Belief elicitation

Survey Questions

Question:

If a randomly selected individual belonging to the **Scheduled Castes** category attempted the Decision task (the task that you just completed). What do you believe is the probability (0% to 100%) that they will answer it correctly?

0% means that they will never get it correct. 100% means that they will always get it correct.



%

Next

Figure D.21: Belief elicitation

Thank you

You have successfully completed the study. We will process the data and a bonus will be sent to you in a few working days, if applicable.

Your Bonus

You have earned a **\$ 0** bonus payment based on your performance on the selected decision. Decision 1 of Task 3 was selected for the bonus.

You have earned a **\$ 0** bonus payment based on your performance on the bonus survey question.

Please click the button at the bottom of the page to complete the study. You must click the button to receive credit for your participation.

Some additional info about the task (in case you are curious):

- The correct answers in the task could be calculated using Bayes' law. We will randomly choose one of the guesses that you made and compare it with the correct answer for that task to calculate your bonus.
- We will check your responses, and will process bonus payments if your answers meet the specified criteria.
- The guesses were indeed made by actual participants in a previous study. However, the names used in the recommendations were fictional nicknames.

Next

Figure D.22: Thank you and debriefing page

Caste – No Signal

Instructions for the Decision Tasks (2/3)

After making the first decision, you will be shown a number.

How is this number generated?

- The computer has access to a pool of participants who made guesses on this exact task in a previous study. They had the same information and saw the same balls as you when making their guess.
- The computer randomly chooses one of these people and shows you the chosen person's guess.

The Second Decision

You have to make a choice:

1. Stick to your first guess, OR
 2. Switch to the shown number.
-

Next, you will learn about how you can earn bonuses on these tasks.

Next

Figure D.23: Instructions 2/3

Example Task (3/3)

The example continues on this page - no bonuses will be awarded for this task, but you have to provide an answer to continue to the next page.

Example Task - The Second Decision

The computer shows:



More info:

- The computer has access to a pool of participants who made guesses on this exact task in a previous study. They had the same information and saw the same balls as you when making their guess.
- The computer randomly chooses one of these people and shows you the chosen person's guess.

Make your Second Decision

Your first guess was: **100 %**.

Based on the information above, **choose one of these options to make your decision (0-100%) that expresses how likely you think it is that the **RED** bag was selected.**

- ☐ **100 %** - Stick to your first guess
- ☐ **73 %** - Switch to the shown number

Next

Figure D.24: Example 3/3

Task Comprehension: First Attempt

You must answer all questions to proceed. You have two chances to do this. If you are unable to pass, the assignment will end immediately and you will not be eligible for approval or for any bonus rewards.

[Click here to review the instructions.](#)

1. You will make several guesses in the tasks. What exactly are you guessing?

- ☐ A number between 0-100, representing your guess about the chance that the RED bag was selected.
- ☐ The probability of a green ball being drawn.

2. Which decision will be used to calculate the bonus?

- ☐ The first decision
- ☐ The last decision
- ☐ One randomly chosen decision

3. If a decision is selected for the bonus, you will get the bonus ...

- ☐ If the selected decision is within 2 % points of the mathematically correct value.
- ☐ By correctly guessing the hard disk capacity of the computer.

4. Before making your second decision, the computer will show you a number. Which of these statements is correct?

- ☐ The shown number is a random number.
- ☐ The shown number is another person's guess.

Next

Figure D.25: Comprehension - No Signal

Task 1 of 6: Second Decision

1 of 6

[See task details](#)

The computer shows:



More info about this guess:

- The computer has access to a pool of participants who made guesses on this exact task in a previous study. They had the same information and saw the same balls as you when making their guess.
- The computer randomly chooses one of these people and shows you the chosen person's guess.

Make your decision

Your first guess was: **88 %**.

Based on the information above, **choose one of these options to make your guess (0-100%) that expresses how likely you think it is that the **RED** bag was selected.**

- ☐ **88 %** - Stick as your first guess
- ☐ **93 %** - Switch to the shown number

Next

Figure D.26: Decision Tasks in *No Signal* - Second decision

Differences in other experiments

The text used to communicate the quality of the source's estimate was different in experiments *Religion*, *Minimal*, *Human*, *Continuous*, and *Computer*. The following screenshots are the instruction screens used in those experiments.

Instructions for the Decision Tasks (4/4)

The example continues on this page - no bonuses will be awarded for this task, but you have to provide an answer to continue to the next page. Below, you will see how to make the second decision.

The second decision

Once you submit your first decision, you will see a page similar to the one below. Here you will see another person's guess on the **same** task. This guess is drawn from a pool of guesses on this task, made by participants in a previous study.

This guess will be randomly chosen by a computer program. There is a chance with which the selected guess will be within $\pm 2\%$ of the correct answer. You then have to make a choice - your second decision can be:

1. The same as your first guess, OR
2. The same as the guess made by someone else.

Remember: Each decision you make is equally likely to be chosen for the bonus, so choose the value that you think is correct.

To proceed with making your decision, click the button below. You will see a guess made by someone else on the same task.

Click to proceed

Figure D.27: Decision Tasks in *Religion* - Instructions

The other person's guess



Mr. P. Mishra

Their Guess: 23%

There is a **60 % chance** that this guess is within ± 2 % points of the correct answer.

More info about this guess: A computer randomly chooses this guess from the guesses made on this exact task by participants in a previous study - they had the same information, and saw the same ball colours when making their guess.

Make your decision

Your first guess was: **100 %**.

Based on the information above, **choose one of these options to make your guess (0-100%) that expresses how likely you think it is that the **RED** bag was selected.**

☐ **100 %** - Same as your first guess

☐ **23 %** - Same as Mr. P. Mishra

Next

Figure D.28: Decision Tasks in *Religion* - Second guess

Task 1 of 6: Guess 2

1 of 6

One of these bags is selected.
The **RED** bag is selected with a **90%** chance.

RED bag
70 **Red**, 30 **Black** balls

90% chance of being selected

BLACK bag
30 **Red**, 70 **Black** balls

10% chance of being selected

The 5 balls are: 

The other person's guess


Study Participant
Their Guess: 97%

There is a **70 % chance** that this guess is close to the correct answer.

More info about this guess:

- This guess is chosen from the guesses made on this exact task by participants in a previous study.
- The computer chooses a guess that is within ± 2 % points of the correct answer with a **70 %** chance.
- This guess was made by someone who had the same information, and saw the same ball colours as you when making their guess.

Make your decision

Your first guess was: **72 %**.

Based on the information above, choose one of these options to make your guess (0-100%) that expresses how likely you think it is that the **RED** bag was selected.

- ☐ **72 %** - Same as your first guess
- ☐ **97 %** - Same as the seen guess

Next

Figure D.29: Decision Tasks in *Human* - Second guess

Survey questions

Below, you see three pairs of paintings. For each pair (on each row), pick the one that you like. Use the radio buttons below to indicate your choice.

Your choices will be used to assign you to a group. Based on your choice, you will be assigned to the **ORANGE** group or to the **PURPLE** group.

#	Image A	Image B	Which do you like?
1			☐ A ☐ B
2			☐ A ☐ B
3			☐ A ☐ B

[Next](#)

Figure D.30: Decision Tasks in *Minimal* - Klee/Kandinsky task

Instructions for the Decision Tasks (4/4)

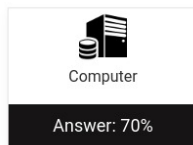
The example continues on this page - no bonuses will be awarded for this task, but you have to provide an answer to continue to the next page. Below, you will see how to make the second decision.

The second decision

Once you submit your first decision, you will see a page similar to the one below. Here you will see a value that is chosen by a computer program in the following way: The computer chooses a value that is within $\pm 2\%$ points of the correct answer with some probability. Otherwise, the computer chooses a random number between 0 and 100. You then have to make a choice. You can choose your second decision to be:

1. The same as your first guess, OR
2. The same as the value generated by the computer.

Remember: Each decision you make is equally likely to be chosen for the bonus, so choose the value that you think is correct.



There is a **60 % chance** that this value is within $\pm 2\%$ points of the correct answer.

More info: The computer chooses a value that is within $\pm 2\%$ points of the correct answer with a **60 %** chance. Otherwise, the computer chooses a random number between 0 and 100.

Make your Second Decision

Your first guess was: **100 %**.

Based on the information above, **choose one of these options to make your decision (0-100%) that expresses how likely you think it is that the **RED** bag was selected.**

- ☐ **100 %** - Same as your first guess
- ☐ **70 %** - Same as the computer

Next, there will be a comprehension test to check whether you have understood these instructions clearly.

Next

Figure D.31: Instructions in *Computer* - Second guess

Task 1 of 6: Guess 2

1 of 6

One of these bags is selected.
The **RED** bag is selected with a **90%** chance.

RED bag
90 **Red**, 10 **Black** balls

90% chance of being selected

BLACK bag
10 **Red**, 90 **Black** balls

10% chance of being selected

The 3 balls are: ●●●

The computer says...



Computer

Answer: 3%

There is a **90 % chance** that this value is close to the correct answer.

More info:

- The computer chooses a value that is within ± 2 % points of the correct answer with a **90 %** chance.
- Otherwise, the computer chooses a random number between 0 and 100.

Make your decision

Your first guess was: **78 %**.

Based on the information above, **choose one of these options to make your guess (0-100%) that expresses how likely you think it is that the **RED** bag was selected.**

- ☐ **78 %** - Same as your first guess
- ☐ **3 %** - Same as the computer

Next

Figure D.32: Decision Tasks in *Computer* - Second guess

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E Pre-analysis plan: *Religion, Minimal* and supporting experiments

This section contains the pre-registration plan that was filed on the AEA Social Science Registry (#0011066), and applies to the *Religion, Minimal*, and *Human vs. Computer* experiments.

WHEN DO WE LISTEN AND WHOM DO WE LISTEN TO? STUBBORNNESS IN SOCIAL LEARNING

Akshay Moorthy

March 14, 2023

1 Introduction

This paper studies the role of preferences in determining how people react to information in social settings. Economists usually approach the decision to learn from others as one that is driven mainly by beliefs – we want to learn from those who may know more than we do, and may choose not to do so if we think we are better at the task than others. While the role of preferences has been studied in the context of motivated reasoning or cognitive biases (Bénabou and Tirole, 2016; Benjamin, 2019), their general role in information demand is largely unexplored. The main idea of this paper is that people may have preferences for whether to listen to others, and to whom they to listen to. I posit that individuals want to learn from those who can help them get to a better outcome (as in standard models), but the *act* of learning from others may be psychologically costly and causes people to not learn when they want to/should. To test this, I run online experiments on Prolific and a panel survey sample.

The experiment has two stages: Participants begin by forming beliefs in a balls-and-urns task, and also state their subjective certainty about their accuracy at the task. Next, they see the another individual’s stated belief, and are provided with a precise signal of its accuracy. Participants have to make a choice – do they stick with their first guess, or switch to what they see? Varying the accuracy and social identity of information sources across experimental conditions, I try to document two taste-based frictions in learning. First, people may be inclined to under react to information regardless of the characteristics of information sources even if they have low subjective certainty in their own beliefs. Second, people may have tastes for the type of the source that are not related to the informational content or performance of the source, leading them to sub-optimally use valuable information.

2 Experiment Design

The experiment is based on the “balls-and-urns” task, which is widely used in experiments studying belief updating and social learning (see Benjamin (2019) for a review). Participants complete 6 belief updating tasks. In each task, there are two urns, which represent two states of the world. The probability with which the states occur $(p, 1 - p)$, $p \in \{0.5, 0.7, 0.9\}$ are known, but the realised state is unknown. Each urn contains 100 balls which are either red or black. One urn contains $\theta \in \{70, 90\}$ red balls, and the other urn contains $100 - \theta$ red balls. One of the urns is randomly selected, and $k \in \{3, 5\}$ balls are drawn (with replacement) from the selected urn. The drawn balls are shown to the participant. Participants use this information to state a belief y_1 , and also state their confidence in this belief. Immediately after making this decision, participants are shown a belief P_S stated by another individual in a previous study. Importantly, the guess P_S is made using the exact same information that the participant has at their disposal. The participant then makes a second decision. The nature of the second decision varies across treatments.

Table 1: Treatment overview

Treatment	Source accuracy	Source identity	Sample	Sample size
Choice	$\{50, 60, 70, 80, 90\}$	None	Prolific	150
Update	$\{50, 60, 70, 80, 90\}$	None	Prolific	150
Lottery	$\{50, 60, 70, 80, 90\}$	None	Prolific	150
Minimal	$\{50, 60, 70, 80, 90\}$	{Orange, Purple}	Prolific	300
Choice	$\{50, 60, 70, 80, 90\}$	None	Panel survey	300
Religion	$\{50, 60, 70, 80, 90\}$	{Hindu, Muslim}	Panel survey	500

Notes. Accuracy is randomised for each task. The identity of the source is randomised at the subject level. In the Lottery treatment, the accuracy corresponds to the probability of winning the lottery.

2.1 Treatments

Table 1 lists the different treatments in the experiment. The characteristics of the information source that individuals see, and the nature of the second decision differ across the various treatment conditions.

Information about the source. In all treatments (except the lottery treatment), participants receive the same information about the source.

There is a $X\%$ chance that this guess is close to the correct answer. This guess is chosen from the guesses made on this exact task by participants in

a previous study. The computer chooses a guess that is within $\pm 2\%$ points of the correct answer with a $X\%$ chance. This guess was made by someone who had the same information, and saw the same ball colours as you when making their guess.

$X \in \{50, 60, 70, 80, 90\}$ is the percentage chance that the guess is within 2 percentage points of the Bayesian posterior. Participants see an inaccurate answer with a $100 - X$ percentage chance.

2.2 Prolific Experiments

Choice. Participants choose whether to stick to their decision, or switch to the value stated by the source.

Update. Participants state a second belief (between 0 and 100) after seeing the source’s decision.

Lottery. In this treatment, participants do not see a source. Participants choose whether to stick to their decision, or switch to a lottery that gives them the bonus with a chance that is the same as the accuracy of the source shown in the other treatments. The lottery is framed as a similar problem as choice, except that a computer draws the correct answer with $X\%$ probability and a random number otherwise.

Minimal. This is the same as choice, except that participants are assigned to a group in a “minimal group” task (Tajfel et al., 1971; Chen and Li, 2009). Participants see sources that belong either to the same group, or to the other group. The decision is the same as in *Choice*.

2.3 Panel survey - Religion and Choice

These sample for these treatments are recruited from a representative online panel of people living in India. The first treatment is the same as *Choice*. In treatment *Religion*, the religious identity of the source is made salient. Sources are given nicknames that indicate whether they are Hindu or Muslim. The decision is the same as in *Choice*.

2.4 Design details

Incentives. One of the 12 decisions is randomly chosen for a bonus reward. Participants get a \$ 4.50 bonus payment if the chosen decision is within $\pm 2\%$ of the true posterior, else they get nothing. All participants receive a \$ 3 fee for participating in the study.

Sources. The sources are generated from responses in pilot experiments conducted on Prolific who make the stage 1 guesses for each of the tasks. All guesses in this stage were incentivised in a similar way as the incentives for the main study, i.e. a piece wise incentive which increases the closer individuals get to the true posterior. Sources that are shown to participants in the main study are chosen from a pool of responses to the tasks that are within $\pm 2\%$ of the Bayesian posterior.

Choice of parameters. Individuals complete 6 of these tasks, which vary in the parameters. The tasks are pre-defined in the sense that the values of p, m, k and the signals (drawn colours) are fixed. Thus, all individuals see the same tasks, which allows for a more straightforward analysis of their responses. The tasks, corresponding parameters, and other details are listed in Table 2.

Table 2: List of Belief Updating Tasks

#	Base Rate	θ	Draws	True Value	High acc.	Low acc.
1	0.7	70	3 (1)	50	51	25
2	0.7	70	5 (2)	50	48	26
3	0.9	70	3 (2)	95.5	95	76
4	0.9	90	3 (0)	1.2	3	23
5	0.9	70	5 (4)	99.1	97	82
6	0.5	70	5 (4)	92.7	92	77

Notes. θ is the number of red balls in the red bag. The draws column should be read as number of balls drawn (number of red balls drawn). High and low accuracy values of P_S for each task are generated from a previous study. In the Lottery treatment, the accuracy corresponds to the probability of winning the lottery.

2.5 Independent variables

Certainty – a participant’s subjective certainty about the first guess.

Accuracy – the percentage chance with which the seen guess is within ± 2 of the Bayesian posterior.

Identity – The identity of the person making the guess. It is coded to represent whether it is the in- or the out- group relative to the relevant identity (MGI group or religion) of the participant.

Should switch is a dummy variable = 1 when a participant’s *Certainty* is 10% points lower than *Accuracy*. We will construct variables with different cutoffs (0,5,10,20).

First guess, a number between 0 and 100, the first guess made by a participant.

2.6 Outcome variables

Choice which is a dummy variable = 1 when a participant chooses to switch to the seen decision.

Second guess, a number between 0 and 100 indicating the second guess made by a participant (in the continuous treatment).

Update is the difference between *First guess* and *Second Guess* in the continuous treatment.

2.7 Survey module

Individualism. The experiment includes 8 questions that measure Horizontal and Vertical Individualism. These measures are taken from the scale developed by Triandis and Gelfand (1998). Answers are coded on a scale from 1 to 5, with 1 indicating “Strongly disagree” and 5 indicating “Strongly agree”. The questions are:

I would rather depend on myself than others.

I rely on myself most of the time. I rarely rely on others.

I often do my own thing.

My personal identity, independent of others, is very important to me.

It is important that I do my job better than others.

Winning is everything.

Competition is the law of nature.

When another person does better than I do, I get tense.

Reflection question. We ask respondents to type free form responses to:

Please tell us how you approached the decision tasks. Did you think differently about the first and second guesses in each task?

Demographics. We ask individuals for their age, sex, education level, and employment status. In the religion treatments, we also ask for their religion.

3 Hypotheses and estimation

There are two main hypotheses:

1. There will be a significant fraction of people who ignore sources when their stated confidence is low relative to the accuracy of the seen guess. For this analysis, we will pool data from all Prolific participants, and also look at this separately by treatment. We also hypothesise that this fraction will be lower in *Lottery* than in *Choice*.

2. At a given level of accuracy, the fraction of people who choose to update their guess is higher when the source is 1. an in-group member in *Minimal*, and 2. when the source belongs to the same religion in *Religion*. We will estimate the treatment effects using OLS, controlling for the level of accuracy of the source, and will show specifications with and without controlling for demographics.

Individualism. The experiment includes a short survey module that measures Horizontal and Vertical Individualism. The hypothesis is that individualism (aggregate of horizontal and vertical) is correlated with a. higher confidence, and b. a reluctance to switch to the source/update beliefs (conditional on confidence).

Robustness/Alternate specifications. We will estimate the main analyses separately when the source is and is not accurate (the realisation of whether an accurate or inaccurate guess is shown as the source is randomly drawn at the time of the task). We will also look at subsamples with high accuracy sources (above 80%).

4 Exclusions

- Participants who fail the comprehension test twice will be completely excluded from the study.
- Results excluding participants who complete the tasks in a very short amount of time will be presented in the appendix. The main results will include these individuals.
- The comprehension test contains one question that will not be evaluated, but serves as a test of whether the individual understands the task well or not. Results excluding individuals who answer this question incorrectly will be presented in the appendix.

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F Pre-analysis plan: *Caste* and related experiments

This section contains the pre-registration plan that was filed on the AEA Social Science Registry (#0011924), and applies to the *Caste* and *Caste – No Signal* experiments.

WHOM DO WE LISTEN TO? PREFERENCES IN SOCIAL LEARNING

Pre-analysis plan

Akshay Moorthy

September 11, 2023

1 Introduction

This pre-analysis plan is for a set of additional treatments that will build on the results of a previous experiment (registered at Moorthy (2023)). The aims of this phase of the project are to study:

1. How does identity (both of the self and of the source) affect information demand?
Is this driven by preferences or beliefs?
2. Do differences in learning because of the identity of the information source persist when the quality of information is independent of the identity of the source?
3. How do people respond to information about the quality of an information source?
Are people differentially sensitive to information about the quality of caste out-group sources than to the quality of caste in-group sources?

2 Experiment Design

The experiment is based on the “balls-and-urns” task, which is widely used in experiments studying belief updating and social learning (see Benjamin (2019) for a review). In each task, there are two urns, which represent two states of the world. The probability with which the states occur $(p, 1 - p)$, $p \in \{0.5, 0.9\}$ are known, but the realised state is unknown. Each urn contains 100 balls which are either red or black. One urn contains $\theta \in \{70, 90\}$ red balls, and the other urn contains $100 - \theta$ red balls. One of the urns is randomly selected, and $k \in \{3, 5\}$ balls are drawn (with replacement) from the selected urn. The drawn balls are shown to the participant. Participants use this information to make a guess y_1 about the probability that the balls were drawn from the first urn, and

also state their confidence in this guess. Each task has a mathematically correct solution – the bayesian posterior P_T .

After making this decision, participants are shown a value between 0-100, P_S , which is associated with a source S . Participants are then asked to make a second decision: whether to stick to their first guess, or switch to the shown value P_S .

Participants see two pieces of information:

1. The surname of the source S , which makes the caste *identity* of S salient,
2. The *quality* of the shown value, which is the probability that P_S is incentive maximising.

Participants complete 6 tasks, and they make two decisions in each task for a total of 12 decisions (y_n). One of the 12 decisions is randomly chosen for a bonus reward. Participants get a \$ 3 bonus reward if $|y - P_T| \leq 2\%$, else they do not get a bonus reward. All participants receive \$ 2 for participating in the study. All fees are paid in the form of “channel points” equivalent to the stated dollar amounts.

2.1 Sample

The sample for these treatments are recruited from a representative online panel of people living in India. Recruitment is restricted to Hindus (based on information available to the survey company). Table 1 lists the various treatments and the target sample sizes for each treatment.

Table 1: Treatment overview and sample size

Source quality	Source caste identity	
	G – General Caste	O – SC/ST/OBC
No Quality	150	150
Quality	450	450

Notes. G - General category (Brahmins and Forward Castes). O - caste categories that do not fall under the General category (Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes, and Other Backward Classes). Cells show the target number of respondents for each treatment.

2.2 Treatments

The treatments are a 2×2 manipulation of *identity* and *quality* information.

Identity information

Participants are randomised (between-subjects) into treatment group G or O . The caste identity of the source is made salient through surnames that are informative of the caste category of the individual. In G , surnames belonging to the General (or “Forward Castes”) category are used. In O , surnames belonging to the Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes, or Other Backward Classes (SC/ST/OBC) are used.

The list of surnames used for G and O have been validated for recognisability through a separate survey that was conducted through the same survey provider. 200 individuals were incentivised to correctly classify a list of surnames into one of the four caste categories.¹ The names used for G type sources are: Banerjee, Bharadwaj, Chaturvedi, Iyer, Mishra, and Tiwari. The names used for O type sources are: Bhil, Chamar, Jatav, Manjhi, Mahar, and Paraiyar.

Quality information

Participants are also randomised (between-subjects) into treatment group *Quality* or *No Quality*. In *No Quality*, participants only see the caste identity of the source, and that the shown values were collected in a previous study. The following information is presented to participants in this treatment:

The computer has access to a pool of participants who made guesses on this exact task in a previous study. They had the same information and saw the same balls as you when making their guess. The computer randomly chooses one of these people and shows you the chosen person’s guess.

In treatment *Quality*, participants are informed about the quality of the source, which can be either 50% or 90%. This varies within-subject, and is randomly chosen for each of the 6 tasks. The following information is shown to participants in this treatment (differences from the *No Quality* treatment are emphasized):

The computer has access to a pool of participants who made *correct* guesses on this exact task in a previous study. They had the same information and saw the same balls as you when making their guess. The computer randomly chooses one of these people and shows you *a number*:

- *With $X\%$ probability, the shown number is the chosen person’s correct guess.*
- *Otherwise, the shown number is incorrect.*

¹These individuals completed large parts of the training module and comprehension tests that will be used in the main treatments. For G , the chosen surnames are the same surnames as used in the previous experiment. The source of truth for the surnames are either common knowledge, or are official classifications of individuals belonging to these communities.

Design Details

Task parameters. Individuals complete 6 of these tasks, which vary in the parameters of the balls-and-urns tasks (namely, the base rates, the signals, and the likelihoods). These parameters are fixed at the task level – all participants see the same tasks in a randomised order. This allows for a clear rational benchmark, and a more direct analysis of participant responses. The tasks, corresponding parameters, and other details are listed in Table 2.

Shown values. The shown values associated with the sources are generated from responses in pilot experiments and previous studies. These participants made guesses for the set of tasks listed in Table 2. All guesses in this stage were incentivised in a similar way as the incentives for the main study, i.e. a piece wise incentive which increases the closer individuals get to the true posterior. Two sets of source values are formed: A set of correct shown values that are within $\pm 2\%$ of the Bayesian posterior, and a set that is outside this range.² The selected values are chosen such that at least one G and one O participant in the previous study made these responses. Finally, two surnames are assigned to each task – one for G and one for O . The list of names and values are the same for all participants, but the task order is randomised.

Attention and comprehension checks. Participants need to successfully pass attention and comprehension checks embedded in the instruction module in order to be eligible for the participation fee and bonus rewards. Participants have to answer four multiple choice questions that test their knowledge of key issues in the task. This ensures that people who complete the training module are aware of the major features of the experimental task, and have a clear understanding of how the incentives are structured.

2.3 Survey questions

Demographics. We ask individuals for their age, sex, education level, employment status, religion, caste group, religiosity, and a free text response for their favourite religious festival. These questions are asked after participants successfully pass the attention and comprehension tests.

Reflection question. We ask respondents to type free form responses to:

Please tell us how you used the recommendation when making the second decisions in the tasks. How did you think about the choice of using your own decision or the shown number?

²The incorrect values are selected as to not be too far away from the true posterior, to minimise the possibility of inferences made from such answers.

Table 2: List of Belief Updating Tasks

#	Base Rate	θ	Draws	True Value	Correct answer	Incorrect value	G - Name	O - Name
1	0.7	70	3 (1)	50	50	26	Iyer	Paraiyar
2	0.7	70	5 (2)	50	48	70	Chaturvedi	Jatav
3	0.9	70	3 (2)	95.5	97	76	Tiwari	Bhil
4	0.9	90	3 (0)	1.2	3	20	Mishra	Manjhi
5	0.9	70	5 (4)	99.1	97	80	Bharadwaj	Mahar
6	0.5	70	5 (4)	92.7	93	77	Banerjee	Chamar

Notes. Base Rate is the probability that the red bag is selected. θ is the number of red balls in the red bag. The draws column should be read as number of balls drawn (number of red balls drawn). True value is the Bayesian posterior probability. The correct and incorrect values of P_S for each task are generated from a previous study.

The belief and reflection questions are presented after participants complete the decision tasks.

Exposure and Attitudes. Participants are given three survey questions before the end of the study. The first two elicit the extent to which respondents have close associations with people who belong to their religious or caste out-groups. The questions are:

How many of your friends belong to the same [Religion/Caste category] as you?

The final question elicits people’s attitudes towards caste-based affirmative action policies.

Do you support reservations in jobs and educational institutions based on caste?

Belief elicitation. Participants will state their beliefs about the probability that an anonymous person belonging to a caste or religious group will answer the experimental task correctly. These beliefs are incentivised for accuracy – participants earn an additional \$0.50 if they guess the number within $\pm 5\%$ points of the true probability, which is calculated based on a previous study.

If a randomly selected individual belonging to the [Caste group] category attempted the Decision task (the task that you just completed). What do you believe is the probability (0% to 100%) that they will answer it correctly? 0% means that they will never get it correct. 100% means that they will always get it correct.

These questions are asked for the “General” and “Scheduled Castes” caste groups.

3 Hypotheses and analysis plan

3.1 Variables

Source and participant attributes

Identity – The identity of the source, represented by an indicator $G = 1$ if the participant is assigned to treatment group G and 0 if the participant is assigned to O .

Quality (level) – the percentage chance with which the seen value is correct (within ± 2 of the Bayesian posterior). This varies within-subject at the task level in the *Quality* treatment group. Represented by the indicator $H = 1$ when *Quality* = 90% (= 0 when *Quality* = 50%).

Quality/No Quality – an indicator $Q = 1$ if a participant is assigned to the *Quality* treatment group, and 0 if the participant is assigned to the *No Quality* treatment group.

Caste – an indicator $C = 1$ when the participant belongs to the General Castes (G) category, else it is 0 if they belong to the Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes, or Other Backward Classes (O).

In-group – an indicator $I = 1$ when the participant’s caste group (self-reported) is the same as the caste identity of the source (exogenously assigned).

Task-level variables

Switch – a dummy variable = 1 when a participant chooses to switch to the shown number.

First guess – a number between 0 and 100, the first guess made by a participant.

Certainty – a participant’s subjective certainty about the first guess. This is a number between 0 and 100.

3.2 Treatment effects

The first set of analyses will study whether the caste identity of the source affects the decision to switch to the shown value when the quality of the information is not known. To study this, we will estimate the following equation for participants in treatment group *No Quality*:

$$Switch_{i,n} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 G_i + \gamma_i + \nu_n + \epsilon \quad (1)$$

i is a participant who makes a decision of whether or not to switch in task n . $G_i = 1$ if a participant is in treatment G , and 0 otherwise. γ_i is a set of demographic controls (age, gender, whether participant has some tertiary education, and employment status).

ν_n are controls for task order and for individual tasks. Results will be presented with and without these controls. In all cases, standard errors will be clustered at the participant level.

H1 There is a causal effect of the caste identity of the source on whether participants choose to switch to the source: $\beta_1 \neq 0$ when estimating Equation 1 within treatment group *No Quality*.

We will also report estimates of Equation 1 that split the sample by the respondent’s caste category to document patterns in behaviour across caste groups, and estimate a model interacting the caste of the respondent C with the caste of the source (G) to explore whether there are any differences.

In a separate survey, we found that individuals (from a similar sample) possess beliefs that individuals belonging to the General category are more likely to succeed on this task than individuals from the Scheduled Castes category.³ In the experimental context, this translates to beliefs that a source in the G treatment group is more likely to be correct than a source in the O treatment group. In the *No Quality* treatment group, participants are not given any information about the quality of the source. Therefore, if participants hold beliefs as found in the survey, and only care about maximising their rewards from the experiment, then we would expect the sign of β_1 in Equation 1 to be positive.

However, participants’ decision to switch to the source in the experiment may also be driven by preferences for the caste identity of the source. For example, participants may possess beliefs that G individuals are very good at the task, which could lead to a positive treatment effect. But they may also dislike listening to G individuals, and this could lead to a negative treatment effect. Thus, identifying whether people possess preferences for the caste identity of information sources requires that we control beliefs about the quality of the information source. The next set of analyses aim to identify whether people possess such preferences.

3.3 The role of preferences

Treatment group *Quality* is designed to control beliefs about the quality of information sources by providing precise information about the probability with which a source gives the incentive maximising answer. The main idea is to make source quality known, and independent of source identity. Hence, beliefs about groups no longer play a role in the evaluation of information sources which allows for the identification of preferences for the caste identity of information sources. First, consider the following specification (within treatment group *Quality*):

³These beliefs are very similar for respondents from different caste groups.

$$Switch_{i,n} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 G_i + \beta_2 H_{i,n} + \gamma_i + \nu_n + \epsilon \quad (2)$$

Where $H_{i,n}$ is the quality of the source seen by individual i in task n .

The coefficient β_1 is the average treatment effect: $\beta_1 > 0$ would mean that participants prefer G sources to O sources. However, participants in our setting possess caste identities (either G or O) which may influence their decision of whether to switch to a G or O source. If people have preferences for sources belonging to their in-groups, G participants would prefer G sources, O participants would prefer O sources, and β_1 would estimate the average of these different group level effects. Because of this, we hypothesise that the average treatment effect from estimating Equation 2 within treatment group *Quality* will not be distinguishable from 0.

To study in-group preferences for information sources, we build on Equation 2 by adding terms for the participant's caste group, and the interaction between participant and source caste group:

$$Switch_{i,n} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 G_i + \beta_2 C_i + \beta_3 C_i \times G_i + \beta_4 H_{i,n} + \gamma_i + \nu_n + \epsilon \quad (3)$$

The indicator C_i is the caste group of the participant: $C = 1$ if the participant belongs to caste group G , else it is 0. Here, the coefficient β_1 is the treatment effect of seeing a G source relative to an O source for O caste participants. $\beta_1 + \beta_3$ is the treatment effect of seeing a G source relative to an O source for G caste participants. The interaction coefficient β_3 is the difference in the treatment effects between G and O caste participants.

H2 Within treatment group *Quality*:

A. There is a positive causal effect of the source being G for G participants. $\beta_1 + \beta_3 > 0$ when estimating Equation 2 restricting the sample to $C = 1$.

B. There is a negative causal effect of the source being O for O participants. $\beta_1 < 0$ when estimating Equation 3 restricting the sample to $C = 0$.

C. The difference in switching because of the caste identity of the source varies by the caste group of the respondent. $\beta_3 \neq 0$ when estimating Equation 3.

We can also look at the entire sample to see whether there is evidence of a general in-group preference for the identity of information sources:

$$Switch_{i,n} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 I_i + \beta_2 H_{i,n} + \gamma_i + \nu_n + \epsilon \quad (4)$$

Where $I_i = 1$ if the caste category of the respondent is the same as the treatment group (G or O).

H3 There is a positive causal effect of switching to a source when the source has the same caste identity as the participant. $\beta_1 > 0$ when estimating Equation 4 within treatment group *Quality*.

3.4 The role of beliefs

Next, we turn to studying how the demand for information reacts to beliefs about the quality of information sources. The experiment design allows us to causally identify whether an increase in the quality of information induces people to switch more to the information source. We can also study whether the responsiveness to an increase in the quality of information interacts with the caste identity of either the source or the participant.

First, we look at how people react to an increase in the quality of information. Standard models of information demand predict that if people value accuracy, then an increase in the quality of information should lead to an increase in switching.

H4 In Equation 2: $\beta_2 > 0$, indicating that participants are responsive to the quality of information, and switch more when information quality increases.

Next, we look at whether the responsiveness to the quality of information (H4) depends upon the caste identity of the source. We can study this by adding an interaction term to Equation 2:

$$Switch_{i,n} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 G_i + \beta_2 H_{i,n} + \beta_3 G_i \times H_{i,n} + \gamma_i + \nu_n + \epsilon \quad (5)$$

The interaction term can be interpreted as the difference between the responsiveness to information quality between a G and an O type source. A non-zero coefficient would imply that individuals respond differently to an increase in information quality depending on the identity of the source. If there is variation between groups, this would suggest that people's preferences for the identity of information sources also affect their sensitivity to an increase in the quality of the information source. Based on suggestive evidence from a

previous study, we hypothesise that participants are likely to be more responsive to the quality of information for O sources, than for G sources.

H6 Participants are more responsive to the quality of information of O sources, than of G sources. $\beta_3 < 0$ when estimating Equation 6 within treatment group *Quality*.

We will also explore whether these patterns vary by the caste identity of the participants by estimating Equation 5 separately for each respondent caste category. Based on suggestive evidence from a previous study, we hypothesise that G participants will respond less to an increase in the quality of G than of O sources, and O participants will respond equally to an increase in the quality of G and O sources.

Supporting Analyses

We will also present results from a battery of robustness tests, as well as a few exploratory analyses:

- Responses on the first task (of the 6),
- Analyses with and without individuals who complete the survey very quickly or very slowly (different cutoffs will be presented),
- Median splits by the error made on the first guess, and by distance of the first guess and the shown value,
- Splits by task difficulty (gauged by error rates in the first guess),
- We will estimate the main analyses splitting the sample by the realisation of whether an accurate or inaccurate value is shown.
- The last of the 6 tasks presented to participants will be the same as one of the previous tasks. This feature of the design will be used to estimate a measure similar to the test-retest correlation.
- Analyses exploring the heterogeneity in switching behaviour by participants' self-reported beliefs about the probability of success on the task of various groups, religiosity, exposure to individuals from other social groups, and attitudes on affirmative action policies will be shown.

4 Exclusions

- Participants who fail the comprehension test twice will be excluded from the study.

- Results excluding participants who complete the tasks in a very short or very long amount of time will be presented in the appendix (varying the cutoff). The main results will include these individuals.
- Participants whose first guess is within 1 percentage point of the shown value will be excluded from the main analysis, as the outcome variable will not be meaningful in such cases.

References

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